



PROGRESS REPORT

Connectivity: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-26

Edition of 2026-08-26 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

57 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

ALGERIA · ANGOLA · BENIN · BOTSWANA · BURKINA FASO · BURUNDI · CAMEROON · CAPE VERDE ·
CENTRAL AFRICAN REPUBLIC · CHAD · COMOROS · CONGO · COTE D'IVOIRE · DJIBOUTI · DR CONGO · EGYPT ·
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Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
"All Fiber" national fibre programme (copper phase-out)	Phase-out announced, 2027 target (2025-05)	3.4m of 7m fixed-internet subscribers on fibre (2026-05)	ADVANCED, ON SUBSCRIBER NUMBERS RATHER THAN ON THE PHASE-OUT DATE
4G base-station expansion (345 new stations, 44 wilayas)	No expansion programme on record	345 stations across 44 wilayas, toward 4,500 localities by 2027	ADVANCED
5G — three commercial licences (Mobilis, Djezzy, Ooredoo)	Tender launched, no award (2025-06)	Ooredoo live in all wilayas, Djezzy in 18 (2026-03)	ADVANCED
GSM licence renewal by executive decree (Mobilis, Optimum/Djezzy)	No renewal instrument on record	Draft decrees examined; term, fee and coverage obligations not published	ADVANCED
IPv6 generalisation	No IPv6 programme on record	Generalisation ordered; no completion date	ADVANCED
Satellite-ISP (NGSO) licensing — two licences	No NGSO licensing route	Tender open for two licences, no award (2026-08)	ADVANCED
Electronic-communications market-entry regimes (Law 18-04)	Two private cabled-network authorisations, no simple-declaration applications (2024-12-31)	No later regulator position held	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Italy-Algeria submarine cable (Algerie Telecom with Sparkle)	MoU signed (2025-07)	MoU only; no build contract, route or landing date	NO CHANGE
National 400G WDM optical backbone (Algerie Telecom with Huawei)	In service (2025-02)	In service; no capacity update since	NO CHANGE

Angola

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
2Africa Angola branch	Not in service; the cable had berthed but the branch and landing station were still being built	In service on a US\$43m operator-built branch, with 23.6 Tbps of the cable's capacity allocated to Angola, replacing an end-of-life system and one at capacity	ADVANCED
Africell network in Cabinda	Did not exist	20 telecom towers installed and satellite backhaul agreed, with commercial voice, data and satellite-linked service stated as starting within days	ADVANCED
Digital terrestrial television transition	Did not exist as a financed project	About US\$10m of foreign financing modernising transmitters at three sites, motivated partly by disaster-alert broadcasting; no progress or switchover date published since	ADVANCED
Enterprise 5G service	Phase-one technical specifications being finalised, not commercially launched	Commercially launched in Cabinda, with Luanda at over 70% city coverage, about US\$20m budgeted and every provincial capital targeted by 2027	ADVANCED
Equiano capacity through Namibia	Did not exist	The state operator to receive an initial 1.0 Tbps of dedicated capacity through a Namibian landing, with an option to assume ownership; design, testing, commissioning and handover still to run	ADVANCED
Low-orbit satellite licence	A 15-year licence granted in June 2025 with a Luanda ground station, first and only licensed low-orbit operator, no commercial offtake on file	Licence held and now commercially deployed through a multi-year capacity agreement with a local provider	ADVANCED
Fifth-generation standalone network	Core transformation completed and a standalone trial call done, with no commercial launch	Unchanged; no held source records a commercial standalone launch date	NO CHANGE
National broadband network	Financed and active, with no delivery milestone published	Financed and active, still with no delivery milestone	NO CHANGE
National terrestrial fibre length	Already inconsistent at 22,000 km in 2023, itself an older figure, against a recurring 2,000 km annual increment	22,000 km in 2023, 20,000 in October 2025, 30,000 in November 2025, 22,000 in April 2026 and 28,000 in June 2026; the wiki asserts no current national figure	NO CHANGE
Starlink licence	Unlicensed, with the ministry saying only that negotiations were continuing	Unlicensed; a secretary of state says only that the process is under way, and the regulator is still working out how to fit low-orbit operators into a regime written for terrestrial networks	NO CHANGE
Domestic submarine cable	BASELINE NOT HELD	A planned domestic cable to interlink the coastal cities and connect a transport corridor to an international system; no route, cost, financier or date published	Baseline not held

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Rural roaming and infrastructure-sharing programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	National roaming and infrastructure sharing with shared towers, solar power and satellite backhaul, extending voice and data to remote areas	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Benin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
5G networks	One 5G operator (MTN, 2024)	Two operators, after Moov Africa Bénin	ADVANCED
National fibre backbone	In service	More than 3,000 km underpinning the service estate	NO CHANGE

Botswana

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
MTC Namibia and BoFiNet cross-border fibre memorandum	No agreement on file (2025-08)	Delivered on its first leg: MTC has completed the Gobabis-Buitepos fibre link, now interconnecting with BoFiNet at Charles Hill, which the two sides describe as the first direct cross-border fibre link between the operators. The remaining 4G gaps along the Trans-Kalahari Corridor are costed at about N\$52 million across 13 new sites	ADVANCED
Powertel-Paratus fibre corridor	Public-private agreement signed June 2025, no route carrying traffic	Phase 1 live at 800Gbps equipped on equipment rated over 10Tbps; phase 2 Bulawayo-Livingstone due September 2026	ADVANCED
BoFiNet internet gateway upgrade	P100m upgrade complete: metro networks replaced in Gaborone and Francistown, London and Johannesburg exchange equipment upgraded (2025-04-16)	Unchanged; no further gateway investment on file at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE
BoFiNet Local Access Projects 2025/26	Baseline not held	Completed at P43m, extending fibre to three villages and connecting 191 customers with 210 construction jobs created, by an operator reporting P376m revenue, 99.7% service availability across the national fibre backbone and status as one of only five profitable state-owned enterprises operating without government subvention	BASELINE NOT HELD
BTC rural satellite connectivity programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	61 rural villages connected — schools, clinics and community centres — with 105 areas in process; no update on file since	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Internet penetration	BASELINE NOT HELD	2.09m users, 81.4% penetration (end-2025)	<i>Baseline not held</i>
National fibre network length	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 16,000 km of fibre laid, linking South Africa, Namibia, Zimbabwe and Zambia	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Village Connectivity Project	BASELINE NOT HELD	Running; no site count, target, budget or completion date published	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Burkina Faso

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Digital planning observatory	Recommended by a 2019 master plan, with ministry work to make it operational since 2023	A live geospatial platform on eight functional objectives covering network mapping, infrastructure sharing and duplicate-investment reduction, built to international mapping recommendations	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Domain-name security extensions	Not deployed	Cryptographic signing live on the country-code domain's records	ADVANCED
Fibre and video-surveillance project	Under construction since July 2021 on a 54-month schedule	650 km of backbone plus 150 km of city links, 900 surveillance cameras and 300 video-surveillance sites, on a Chinese concessional loan of RMB 560m	CLOSED
New public-administration network	Network reinforcement and further interconnection named as a priority, with 38 structures interconnected in the first half of 2025	Architecture of the replacement network complete and equipment procurement in evaluation, with the existing network operating since 2007 and 88 to 100 further buildings connected in 2025	ADVANCED
Operator site-build commitments	800 new sites planned for 2025 across the fund and the acceleration project, tender in progress	2025 commitments delivered in full at 200, 200 and 150 sites across the three operators; for 2026 one operator is at about half of 100 planned and another has five live, twenty installing and 125 in build	ADVANCED
Satellite market authorisation	No authorisation; the regulator declared terminal sales irregular under the 2008 telecommunications law	Still unlicensed, with ministry negotiations reported advancing and a decision pending	ADVANCED
White-zone connectivity programme, first tranche	Tender dossier for 750 localities finalised, project not yet launched	Most localities identified, service orders signed and equipment on order, with delivery targeted before end-2026	ADVANCED
White-zone connectivity programme, second tranche	Not announced	A second lot of 750 localities announced for 2027, with no separate financing line stated	ADVANCED
Wholesale price on the national fibre backbone	About 90 million FCFA a month for a 10 Gb service (2023)	About 35 million FCFA a month for a 10 Gb service (2026), on the operating company's own account of three years running the state-built 3,000 km backbone	ADVANCED
Internet exchange point	Operating since June 2015 at a 6 Gbit/s peak, keeping local traffic flowing through subsea cuts	Operating at a 6 Gbit/s peak with local latency of 15 to 20 milliseconds against over 300 before peering	NO CHANGE
National telecommunications backbone, first phase	307 km in service at 1,600 Gbit/s	307 km in service at 1,600 Gbit/s, the first phase of a stated EUR 175m and 5,740 km programme, with no phase-two status on file	NO CHANGE
Universal access and service fund	Financing 500 of the 800 telecom sites planned for 2025, plus 50 more as zones cleared	Co-financing half the state's FCFA 37.5bn white-zone contribution, levied at 2% of operator turnover	NO CHANGE
Cross-border frequency coordination protocol	BASELINE NOT HELD	Preferential frequencies for operators, interference-prevention mechanisms and 15 km coordination zones either side of the borders with three neighbours	Baseline not held
Interconnection catalogue 2026 to 2028	BASELINE NOT HELD	In force, with call-termination tariffs revised	Baseline not held
National fibre network, deployed length	BASELINE NOT HELD	More than 11,292 km deployed, with 270 km more programmed for 2026	Baseline not held

Burundi

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
PAFEN rural 4G build	Did not exist	Lumitel >US\$10m for 86 hills across 14 provinces; ONATEL US\$5.9m for 92 hills covering 372,035 people	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Mobile and internet network quality	Outages attributed to power, fuel and foreign-exchange shortages (2025-09)	Degraded; ARCT names power cuts, generator fuel supply, unstable REGIDESO supply, urban bandwidth saturation, ageing transmission equipment and missing masts	NO CHANGE
Starlink licence	Licensed, unaffordable	Licensed, unaffordable	NO CHANGE
Fonds de service universel institutional connectivity	Baseline not held	BIF 11.40bn revised, own-source levy, FY2026/27	BASELINE NOT HELD
ICT infrastructure-sharing law	Baseline not held	In draft; no text, tabling date or sponsoring ministry published	BASELINE NOT HELD
PAFEN mast-deployment programme	Baseline not held	Financed and in train; addresses coverage rather than outages	BASELINE NOT HELD

Cameroon

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Chad border fibre link	A cooperation agreement of May 2025 promised the section within fourteen days	Not built; the April 2025 memorandum was suspended on digital-sovereignty grounds and the parties told to revise and re-sign	REGRESSED
Fibre backbone Phase IV	Backbone about 12,000 km; no fourth-phase financing authorised	CNY 1,350,963,161, about FCFA 108.4bn, authorised for a further 4,000 km, a national data centre and regional links to Chad, the Central African Republic and Nigeria	ADVANCED
National fibre backbone length	About 12,000 km terrestrial plus about 812 km overhead (2024 reference year)	Over 15,000 km (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Customs circular on satellite terminal seizures	Systematic seizure of satellite kits at the borders	Still the operative instrument; kits enter through indirect registration abroad, with ten modems seized at one post on 2025-12-12	NO CHANGE

Cape Verde

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
AUDA-NEPAD Programme for African Developing Island Economies	Did not exist	Launched with a 2026-2031 roadmap covering Cabo Verde and six other island states, on six pillars including connectivity, with digital public infrastructure and artificial intelligence named as accelerators	ADVANCED
Starlink share of the internet market	Zero before January 2025; 0.08% at 2025-03-31 by implication of the reported quarterly gain	0.2% of internet subscriptions at 2025-06-30, in a market of 484,929 subscriptions, up 0.12 percentage points on the quarter	ADVANCED
Electronic communications market indicators	484,929 internet subscriptions, 94 accesses per 100 inhabitants, 86% mobile broadband, 592,769 active SIMs at 115% penetration, 61,611 fixed lines (2025-06-30)	Unchanged; no ARME quarter after Q2 2025 is held. Market shares CVTelecom 72.3%, Unitel T+ 27.5%, Starlink 0.2%	NO CHANGE
Sistema de Informacao de Gestao de Dominios .CV	Operating; a localised .cv domain-management system under ARME with OLACV handling registrations	Unchanged; no registration volume, fee schedule or operational report is held	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Starlink Cabo Verde	Operating; 0.2% of the internet market as one of five authorised operators	Unchanged; no market-share figure later than Q2 2025 is held	NO CHANGE

Central African Republic

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Central African Internet Exchange	Did not exist	A national internet exchange point created, described as reinforcing digital sovereignty; no membership, peering or traffic figure held	ADVANCED
Fourth-generation mobile licensing	One operator live since May 2025 and a second licence renewed in January 2025; the third held no licence	All three hold licences, the third licensed in December 2025 and live in May 2026; a licence is not coverage, and 4G population coverage was measured at 0.3% in 2023	ADVANCED
Provincial mobile service outage	Service in operation; the base held nothing on this locality before	Voice, data and mobile money all down with no restoration date, and some officials unpaid for the previous month because salary transfers run over mobile services	REGRESSED
Regulator quality-of-service publication website	Did not exist; the regulator's domain served a placeholder page	Financing obtained; no site recorded as live on a third test at 2026-07-26, and the regulator still publishes no statistics of any kind	ADVANCED
Satellite broadband service	Did not exist: no licence and no service	Commercially live since 2026-03-16 as the operator's 27th African market, with 450 government kits; the monthly subscription is about 136% of monthly income per head; roaming on kits acquired abroad deactivated	ADVANCED
Twelve-thousand-kilometre fibre commitment	Did not exist	A commitment stated by the minister; no contract, financing, route, phasing or timetable is held and no progress in the six months since	ADVANCED
Internet use rate	An international estimate of 13.8% for 2024 and a publisher estimate of 15.5% in January 2025	About 670,000 users, 12.0%, at October 2025, and 2.49m mobile subscriptions, 38.1% penetration, at end-2025	NO CHANGE
National fibre backbone	935 km of terrestrial and sub-fluvial fibre in service on the Bangui-Douala corridor with spurs to Cameroon and Congo	Unchanged; no new kilometrage, commissioning or route added through 2026-08-06, while the 2026 estimates appropriate FCFA 2,000,000 to connect prefecture capitals to Bangui over it	NO CHANGE
Passive infrastructure licence	A licence signed for pylons, antennas and technical sites to be built and leased to the mobile operators, with nothing built	Unchanged: no tower count, site build, operator lease or deployment record through 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE

Chad

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
N'Djamena to Mbere fibre corridor memorandum	Memorandum signed in April 2025, with a neighbouring incumbent committing the following month to build the connecting section, and no work started	Suspended by the regulator over clauses deemed contrary to national digital sovereignty; the ministry issued observations and guidelines and invited renegotiation, and work is still not started	REGRESSED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Network investment programme of the larger mobile operator	The minister told the National Assembly on 2025-09-23 that the operator had promised FCFA 16bn in the short term and FCFA 10bn in the medium term, and that this had never been done	FCFA 50bn announced through June 2026 for microwave reinforcement, new towers, fibre extension and core-network upgrade; the deadline passed and the ministry's verdict on operator investment in June 2026 was that nothing is felt	STALLED
Order to the two mobile operators to connect to the national fibre backbone	Did not exist	The seven-day deadline passed with no recorded compliance; in late June 2026 the minister was still encouraging one operator to connect and criticising its reliance on subcontractors for equipment, technical staff and site maintenance	STALLED
Projet de modernisation des infrastructures de connectivite de l'Etat	Under construction since the foundation stone of 2020-07-07, with the EUR 175.1m first phase not commenced and no delivery figure published	First phase commenced at EUR 175,106,916 covering the national data centre, a 1,200 km fibre backbone, second- to fourth-generation mobile expansion, a conference and messaging system and 100 branch offices; no source reports kilometres laid, masts erected or the state operator's core commissioned	ADVANCED
Starlink operating licence	Licence signed 2025-03-13 on an approval dated November 2024, with no commercial service on sale	On sale from 2025-07-04 at FCFA 12,000 a month for 50 GB, FCFA 18,000 for 250 GB and FCFA 32,000 unlimited; confirmed in October 2025 as a multiservice internet-provider licence granted on application after a favourable technical opinion and without public tender, and a floated upgrade to full operator status was closed a month later	ADVANCED
TCHADIX internet exchange point	Operational since about May 2025, with no published traffic, membership or peering figure	One year operational and constituted as an economic interest grouping with adopted statutes and a reconfirmed bureau; still no published traffic volume, member count or peering figure	ADVANCED, INSTITUTIONALISED
Trans-Saharan fibre-optic backbone, Chadian section	32 per cent complete at a ministerial field visit of 2025-03-06, works having been launched in May 2023 on an initial ten-month schedule	60 per cent complete; a mission to Bol in January 2026 found broken windows and degradation at the technical building housing equipment, and the project coordinator conceded a slowdown from difficulty mobilising control missions	ADVANCED, STILL FAR BEHIND SCHEDULE
Fifty telecom sites and fifty kilometres of fibre to the home at N'Djamena	No position held	Announced through the state operator with no timeline, financing or coverage areas specified, and no build reported	BASELINE NOT HELD
Twenty-year concession for a border-to-border fibre link	No position held	A twenty-year build-operate-transfer concession from the Sudanese border to Cameroon, with a funding commitment of FCFA 20.5bn from European and continental development financiers; no progress has been made	BASELINE NOT HELD

Comoros

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Entry fibre tariff	KMF 32,500 a month for the basic fibre offer at 800 GB	KMF 30,000 a month at 850 GB with unlimited fixed-line calls, plus embedded subscriber-identity migration at KMF 5,000 and a new one at KMF 10,000	ADVANCED
Comores Telecom fifth-generation and fixed-wireless service	Live at the Hamramba pilot site at a claimed rate of up to 1 Gbit/s	Unchanged - no second site, and no coverage or subscriber figure published since launch	NO CHANGE
Incumbent operator annual revenue	KMF 17,035,000,000 for 2024, up 0.91 per cent on 2023	No 2025 outturn published, so the target is untested at the close of the window	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Prohibition on satellite internet deployment	In force, with installation, testing, deployment and use all prohibited and no licence issued	Still in force on the record; no licence, no lifting and no enforcement outcome is held	NO CHANGE
Yas Comores fifth-generation service	Live in two districts of the capital, with extension to the other two islands announced	Unchanged on the record; the group's own 2026 restatement confirms fifth-generation and fibre live in the capital and names no new site	NO CHANGE
National digital connectivity project	Baseline not held	The African Development Bank and the Multilateral Cooperation Center for Development Finance told the finance ministry on 2026-08-10 that they are ready to fund the feasibility studies as a grant, the project being carried by the national digital development agency and covering data-centre studies and inter-island connectivity; no commitment amount, study contract or timetable is stated	BASELINE NOT HELD

Congo

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Alternative submarine cable connection	Nothing held on the country's submarine position at the window's start	Reliance on one cable since 2012 established, a switch announced as three weeks away, and one alternative cable delayed	ADVANCED, NO COMPLETION ON FILE
Digital transformation acceleration project	A 2025 work plan of just over FCFA 21bn, described by the national coordinator as carrying over 2024 activities begun and not closed	A 2026 budget of FCFA 21,872,000,000 on three axes – rural connectivity, a multimedia centre and interior-ministry applications – inside a consolidated envelope of EUR 136.5m across a World Bank loan, an EU grant and a European bank loan, to a 2027 horizon	ADVANCED
National backbone transferred to the state operator	Earlier phases held by the operator as usufruct, with no formal contribution and no capital entry	Assets valued at FCFA 143,878,429,945 contributed in kind, share capital raised to FCFA 157,297,453,418 and accumulated losses of just over FCFA 20bn absorbed, staged explicitly to prepare a listing	ADVANCED
Quality-of-service enforcement against the two mobile operators	Did not exist: no formal enforcement action is on file at the window's start	Formal notices with a six-month clock and per-department scores published; one operator absent from fourth-generation service in five named localities, against eleven interior localities now covered where none was at end-2024	ADVANCED
Rural broadband site programme	A European limb of FCFA 27bn launched in June 2025 with no operational-site count held	76 sites built and equipped with 20 fully operational and 56 in advanced stages, an additional US\$3m allocated to upgrade sites to fourth-generation service, and 16 rural localities across six departments commissioned	ADVANCED, RATED UNSATISFACTORY AT MID-TERM
Universal access and service fund	The fund committee set a 2025 target of ten multimedia centres and 100 connected sites, stating only an intention to mobilise 1% of operator turnover, on a three-year record of 200 sites connected	The first appropriation figure on file, FCFA 1,000,000,000 for 2026, spent entirely as transfers; two further towns connected to the national grid in January 2026	ADVANCED
Mobile backhaul spectrum fees as a share of operator revenue	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 5% of operators' total revenue against a sub-Saharan median of 0.5%, alongside delayed spectrum assignments, cross-border interference and technology-neutrality restrictions	Baseline not held

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Rural mobile-internet population coverage	BASELINE NOT HELD	Rural coverage of 33% for third-generation and 21% for fourth-generation service, with almost 80% of the rural population outside fourth-generation coverage and half outside any coverage, against about 86% national coverage and 19% unique mobile-internet use	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Cote d'Ivoire

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
5G commercial launch	Spectrum re-planned and financial terms settled after a missed 2023 target, with the regulator calling deployment imminent	Announced for July 2026 in towns above 25,000 inhabitants with all operators said to be equipped; no launch, spectrum award terms or coverage obligation on file	STALLED
Deployed optical fibre	30,303 km deployed nationally	About 38,000 km, with connectivity reaching nearly one million homes; the state broadband backbone accounts for over 6,600 km	ADVANCED
Mobile coverage and internet users	4G covering 73.34% of localities and 93.71% of the population; the universal-service agency put territorial coverage at 82%	95% mobile coverage, telecom penetration above 130% of population, nearly 15m active internet users and about 2m e-commerce users; smartphone adoption 41%	ADVANCED
Programme national de connectivite rurale	Site activations began July 2025; 575 localities and 825,675 residents targeted by December 2025	500 villages connected under the 2025 emergency programme, with 300 more localities planned for 2026 and no completion statement against the 575 target	ADVANCED, SLIPPED
Starlink Network CIV	Not authorised to sell; the regulator had threatened sanctions in 2024 for supplying internet without authorisation	Selling nationally on a 12-month provisional licence reviewable on service quality, hardware XOF 148,148 to 247,466 and service from XOF 28,746 a month	ADVANCED
CIVIX national internet exchange point	Operating; a memorandum signed June 2025 to colocate a third point of presence at a Grand-Bassam facility	Operating with Netflix and Akamai peering alongside operators and ISPs at 36 Gbps daily average	NO CHANGE
National IPv6 migration strategy	Strategy and action plan validated with about twenty public and private bodies; IPv6 penetration 6.6%	Unchanged; no adoption, no publication and no later penetration figure on file as at 2026-08-05	NO CHANGE
2Africa Ivory Coast branch	BASELINE NOT HELD	All services live after repair; WACS repairs expected the following week	<i>Baseline not held</i>
MTN satellite broadband	BASELINE NOT HELD	Hybrid geostationary and low-orbit capacity aimed at rural white areas; no subscriber, price or coverage figure on file	<i>Baseline not held</i>
National strategy to protect electronic-communications infrastructure	BASELINE NOT HELD	Operators, infrastructure managers and the regulator working towards a protection strategy after 665 acts of theft and vandalism nationally between January and October 2025; no instrument published	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Orange Sat satellite broadband	BASELINE NOT HELD	Satellite broadband sold by the incumbent into rural white areas on leased geostationary capacity; no subscriber, price or coverage figure on file	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Predictive fibre-cut sensing	Baseline not held	An operator and its vendor completed a proof of concept in Abidjan detecting vibrations around fibre ducts and classifying them to flag third-party excavation before a cut happens, on long-term trials run since 2025; no commercial deployment, coverage or date is stated	BASELINE NOT HELD

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
RASCOM capacity in universal coverage	BASELINE NOT HELD	Government has chosen satellite for areas terrestrial infrastructure serves poorly and intends to route regional satellite capacity through the universal-service bodies; no terms, tariff or timetable stated	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Via Africa submarine cable	BASELINE NOT HELD	Europe-to-South Africa Atlantic system with an Ivorian landing; route survey funded and supplier selection being prepared, with no landing date, capacity or cost stated	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Djibouti

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
DARE1 southern extension (Mombasa-Mtunzini)	No southern extension on record	Extension announced; 36 Tbit/s over about 3,200-3,500 km, ready for service 2028	ADVANCED
Djibouti Digital Foundation and EARDIP domestic fibre rollout	Ali-Sabieh regional hospital connected, over 200 km deployed (2025-06)	Damerjog in Arta added; stakeholder and grievance workshop covering Djibouti-ville, Balbala and the five interior regions (2025-10)	ADVANCED
Horizon Fiber terrestrial corridor (Djibouti-Addis-Port Sudan)	Memorandum of understanding only (2024-12)	Binding agreement signed; about 2,800 km, 144 fibre pairs, about 14 ms latency (2026-02)	ADVANCED
Italian cable inspection and protection project (Med-Or, Piano Mattei)	Did not exist	Project reported under a memorandum with the Ministry of Economy and Finance; no amount, term or delivery date	ADVANCED
Djibouti Telecom statutory monopoly (loi 13/1998, loi 80/2004)	Statutory monopoly; no competing licensed operator	Statutory monopoly; no competing licensed operator	NO CHANGE
Internet exchange points (DjIX and AMS-IX Djibouti)	DjIX and AMS-IX Djibouti in operation	DjIX and AMS-IX Djibouti in operation	NO CHANGE
Submarine cable systems landing in Djibouti	12 operational systems reached by the two Wingu facilities (2025-06)	12 systems landing, six of them connected to Italy, carrying about 18% of international submarine cable data (2026-08)	NO CHANGE

DR Congo

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Africa Congo Internet Exchange	Established 2023 and operating from a single presence	A distributed exchange across two carrier-neutral facilities, open to licensed operators, service providers, mobile networks, cloud and content providers	ADVANCED
DRC mobile subscription and internet-penetration statistics (EACO regional report)	No EACO/ARPTC-sourced figure held	73.93m mobile subscriptions, 67.8% penetration (from 63.96m/60.5% in 2024); 36.98m mobile-internet subscriptions, 33.9% penetration; mobile-internet revenue US\$970.2m in 2025, nearly matching voice revenue; DRC reports no mobile-money transaction value to EACO	ADVANCED
Goma-Mombasa fibre route	Did not exist	Eastern DR Congo tied into the East African terrestrial corridor to the Indian Ocean	ADVANCED
National digital transformation project fibre backbone	The programme running about a year with no deployed-kilometre figure held; the June 2025 Council recorded 30.79% mobile-internet and under 0.02% fixed access	7,000 km deployed against a target of more than 18,500 km, leaving 11,500 km outstanding, tied to connecting 145 territories by 2030	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
5G public consultation	The consultation open since 2025-03-18 with no outcome published	Unchanged: no consultation report, spectrum award, licence or revised timetable seventeen months later	NO CHANGE
Rural solar base-station joint venture	Announced January 2025: up to 2,000 solar 2G and 4G base stations over six years, reaching about 19m people	The same commitment restated sixteen months later with a 2031 date; no sites-built count, spend figure or first-phase milestone at either end	NO CHANGE
Sovereign satellite programme	A memorandum signed November 2024; cost estimated at US\$400m and said to be mobilised	Unchanged: no contract, operator selection, build or launch date, and no revised cost on record in the following twelve months	NO CHANGE
State telecommunications and postal operator	A national conference on posts and telecoms named the sector the state's second-largest revenue source and asset spoliation a problem to fix	On current finances the company could theoretically pay salaries only every four months; management says rigour has brought the cycle to every two to two and a half months	NO CHANGE
Kinshasa Internet Exchange (KINIX)	Baseline not held	The exchange moved its infrastructure into a carrier-neutral Tier III data centre in Kinshasa; the operators state it connects more than 20 networks with over 1 Tbps of available capacity and expect it to exceed 2 Tbps after the move. It is one of three exchange points under a national exchange project managed by the internet service providers association, and is positioned to become the primary national interconnection hub and a Central African regional exchange	BASELINE NOT HELD
Satellite direct-to-cell service	Baseline not held	Commercially launched on 2026-08-14, the first African operator to move a satellite-to-mobile partnership out of testing; a compatible LTE Android handset with a clear view of the sky reaches messaging, SMS and voice by satellite where there is no terrestrial coverage, with no dish, router or other equipment, the regulator has confirmed a phased rollout, and eligible customers registering through the operator's app get a free 30-day introductory trial	BASELINE NOT HELD

Egypt

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
5G and aggregate mobile download speeds	5G median 110.5 Mbps on launch day and 106.80 Mbps in month one; pre-launch 4G baseline 32.8 Mbps; combined 4G and 5G median 37.68 Mbps	5G median about 89 Mbps at month six; combined 4G and 5G median 34.77 Mbps, below the pre-launch baseline, with 4G down 17%	REGRESSED
Active international submarine cable systems landing in Egypt	13 systems landing on the eastern coast with a stated plan to expand to 18 (2024-11-18, operator-reported)	About 15 active international systems, the largest concentration in Africa (2025-11)	ADVANCED
Fixed broadband subscriptions	11.51 million (2024)	12.60 million (November 2025), up from 12.50 million in October, annual growth 8.98%; mobile carried 75.44% of internet access against 72.97% a year earlier	ADVANCED
Starlink service in Egypt	Advanced ministry negotiations reported 2025-06-18 with a possible launch during that year; no licence, no Egyptian entity	Talks moved to a licensed local operator; no licence, no local entity, no service date, and the operator's own map listed Egypt as service date unknown in May 2026	STALLED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Upper 6 GHz mobile trial	Did not exist	The incumbent, the regulator and a Chinese vendor ran a mobile base station and a data call over upper 6 GHz, reported at about 1.7 Gbps per user and stated by the operator as the first such trial in Egypt and Africa; the regulator frames the band as a capacity addition for high-traffic areas	ADVANCED
2Africa submarine cable, Egypt transit and Mediterranean segment	Mediterranean capacity in service since January 2025, with Egypt a transit hub rather than a terminal landing	Same; the system is stated at about 45,000 km across 33 or more countries, designed for up to 180 Tbps on main routes, with most segments expected complete by 2026 (consortium-reported)	NO CHANGE
5G mobile service	In service since June 2025, initial rollout focused on Cairo and Alexandria, on shared refarmed blocks of 20 MHz to 30 MHz of 2.6 GHz	Same architecture; no coverage obligation, subscriber count or population-coverage figure is held for Egypt at 2026-08	NO CHANGE
AWS CloudFront edge location, Cairo	In operation since May 2024, with a vendor-stated latency reduction of up to about 30% for content delivered in Egypt	Same; no capacity expansion or additional presence is recorded	NO CHANGE
Mobile tower expansion programme	The base carries no tower count or programme statement before February 2026	About 3,000 new towers planned in 2026 and more than 9,000 over three years, towers stated as doubled since 2019, against a target of 40,000 by 2028; more than US\$6bn invested in telecom infrastructure since 2019	BASELINE NOT HELD
Share of popular web content served from inside Egypt	No prior reading is held	15% of popular web content served locally, the majority from European servers; Algeria 13%, South Africa 66%, United States 83%	BASELINE NOT HELD

Equatorial Guinea

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digital Terrestrial Television project	Built but incomplete, with no published switchover date	Under tender for diagnostic, regularisation, rehabilitation, commissioning and operational transfer, Treasury-financed, with no contract value, deadline or switchover date published	ADVANCED, A DIAGNOSTIC TENDER ONLY
Gabon-Equatorial Guinea fibre, roaming and frequency accords	Did not exist	Signed, covering fibre interconnection, free roaming and frequency coordination; no traffic or tariff figure published	ADVANCED
GETESA network modernisation	An operator network with no published modernisation programme	A modernisation programme covering 5G, eSIM, public Wi-Fi and fibre reactivation, on a Huawei network contract	ADVANCED
Nigeria-Equatorial Guinea subsea cable	Did not exist	Agreement signed, bundling a data centre; no route, capacity or delivery date published	ADVANCED
Starlink satellite internet service	Entry signalled in February 2025, not authorised	Authorised temporarily for North American companies' offshore operations inside jurisdictional waters; extension to individual subscribers deferred on stated security grounds, with type-approval and competences still unresolved with ORTEL	ADVANCED
TELGESA, the second state operator	Announced as a new second state operator at about US\$50m, 260 towers and 90% coverage	Merger with Loita Group halted until an audit of GECOMSA establishes its assets, liabilities and debts	STALLED, PENDING AN AUDIT
ACE submarine cable landing	Landing party for ACE through GITGE	Landing party for ACE; capacity unchanged on the record	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Ceiba-1 and Ceiba-2 submarine cables	In service, alongside the ACE landing	In service; no later capacity or utilisation figure is held	NO CHANGE
July-December 2026 connectivity plan	BASELINE NOT HELD	Presented, naming 2G and 4G coverage to 85% through 34 new towers in Annobon and the interior, Roaming Cero with Cameroon, Gabon, Chad and the Central African Republic, and a Sistema Nacional de Codigos Postales Digitales	Baseline not held
Medusa submarine cable connection	BASELINE NOT HELD	Under study, put at EUR 20-60m and 2029-30, with a Via Africa route also named	Baseline not held

Eritrea

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
EriTel national network expansion programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	184 towers and accessories installed; landline renovation in six named towns plus the Naval Force Base; ~73km new cable laid; internet bandwidth risen to ~1,536 Mbps over the past decade; 35bn+ Nakfa cumulative investment claimed	Baseline not held

Eswatini

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Mbabane smart-city deployment	Did not exist	Under installation; no completion date published	ADVANCED
Minimum internet service standard	2 Mbps minimum	10 Mbps proposed; the 2 Mbps standard remains in force	ADVANCED
National fibre-optic backbone	47 Gbps international capacity	72 Gbps international capacity; rollout continuing	ADVANCED
Public-institution connectivity programme	Did not exist	859 schools, 134 health facilities and 38 tinkhundla centres to be connected	ADVANCED
Mobile coverage against mobile-internet use	About 95% 4G coverage against about 58% internet use	95% mobile coverage against 57% mobile-internet subscription (2026-07)	NO CHANGE
Statutory complaint adjudication by ESCCOM	In force	In force	NO CHANGE
Cost of data as a share of income per head	Baseline not held	3.47% of gross national income per head	BASELINE NOT HELD

Ethiopia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Ethio Telecom network	Nationwide incumbent network (2025-08)	99.8% coverage (2026-04) on 90.1m subscribers; 215.8bn Birr revenue in FY2025/26 with data and internet 31.1% of it against mobile voice at 23.5%, operating profit 92.9bn Birr	ADVANCED, IN REACH AND REVENUE
Network expansion contracts from MWC 2026	Did not exist	Ericsson 1,500 sites and 502 upgrades under the MWC contracts; separately, 879 sites completed under the ZTE programme (462 RAN modernisation, 237 microwave-link upgrades, 103 IP RAN sites), 92% 4G population coverage across ZTE's own network footprint, with 124 new sites, 272 U2100 refarming sites and 115 rural sites still to come	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Next Horizon: Digital & Beyond 2028 strategy	Did not exist	A three-year corporate strategy to 2028 carrying six strategic themes, nineteen strategic objectives, four strategic-priority categories and a three-year indicator table, published by the operator on its own site	ADVANCED
Safaricom Ethiopia second network	10.06m 90-day active customers (2025-06)	14.7m 90-day active customers; the development financiers diluted to 9.5% and 6.81% with a right to reacquire; more than 67 existing sites upgraded across nine Southern Region towns against congestion and power-supply problems	ADVANCED
Safaricom regional fibre deployment	Did not exist	Under construction, Afdera to Mekelle	ADVANCED
teleStream and Zero-Touch Broadband	Did not exist	Live	ADVANCED

Gabon

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
ARCEP prohibition on Starlink sale, installation and use	No prohibition on the record	In force - sale, installation and use illegal on penalty of fines, imprisonment and equipment seizure, while the operator's own map still listed Gabon as available from 2026 with no licence granted (2026-05-19)	ADVANCED
GABIX (Gabon Internet Exchange Point)	Two members, ANINF and CanalBox, with local traffic of about 80 Mbps, unchanged since 2019	Gabon Telecom and Airtel Gabon reconnected on 2026-05-13 and local traffic passed 250 Mbps; the national reboot workshop ran 3-8 August 2026 with the Internet Society and AFRINIC and closed with certificates presented after six days of peering, security and sovereignty training. AFRINIC called for a network of trained ambassadors to carry the skills into firms and administrations, and operator representatives named broader institutional buy-in as the remaining task	ADVANCED
Gabon-Equatorial Guinea digital accords	Did not exist	Signed - fibre interconnection, free roaming and radio-frequency coordination; no commencement date, link capacity, tariff or coordination schedule published	ADVANCED
Airtel Gabon technology-neutral fixed-network authorisation	In force; no build obligation, coverage target or deployment figure published	Unchanged; nothing on the record of what has been built under it in nineteen months	NO CHANGE
Central African Backbone additional financing	Closed	Closed, with no successor backbone financing on file	NO CHANGE
Moov Africa Gabon Telecom fibre-to-the-home programme	Nine localities planned for 2025, the programme running since April 2016	Unchanged; no delivery figure, subscriber count or 2026 plan on file	NO CHANGE
Fibre-optic backbone deployed	No figure held	2,000 km deployed (2026-07), against 88 per cent forest cover cited as the physical limit on further fibre	BASELINE NOT HELD

Gambia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
GAMTEL national broadband modernisation PPP	Did not exist	US\$50m partnership signed to take the national backbone from 40 Gbps to 800 Gbps; no completion date, milestone schedule or dalasi figure published (2026-01)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Gambia National Broadband Network (China Eximbank loan)	In service under a US\$25.9m concessional loan repayable by GAMTEL, with a servicing history of arrears (2017 loan)	Unchanged on the record; no statement of network condition, utilisation or debt position since 2020	NO CHANGE
Liberia-Gambia-Sierra Leone roaming agreement	Signed; no tariff, traffic or commencement figure published (2025-08)	Unchanged; no tariff, traffic or commencement figure published (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
Starlink satellite service licence	Fee paid and licence unissued for over a year, the government citing due diligence in the face of United States pressure (2025-07)	Still unlicensed; the minister states Starlink lacks the competencies and equipment for a VSAT permit and requires a general satellite licence instead (2026-05)	NO CHANGE

Ghana

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
5G population coverage target for 2028	None published	70 per cent 5G coverage projected by the end of 2028, alongside a stated review of spectrum policy to encourage investment	ADVANCED
5G spectrum request for applications	Did not exist	Eleven lots across 700 MHz, 2.3 GHz and 3 GHz on a US\$230m aggregate reserve and 15-year licences, amended in seven places by a consolidated response of 2026-07-31; no award made	ADVANCED
Annual fibre cuts	About 3,900 cuts in 2021, at about US\$7.5m in repairs	More than 8,000 cuts in 2025 at about US\$20m in repairs, against a 2022 peak of 10,034 cuts costing US\$17.4m, with 4,289 cuts logged in the first half of 2026	REGRESSED
Cell-site build for 2026	223 new sites a year on the ten-year average	1,150 new sites planned for 2026 across two operators, with the regulator putting more than 500 under construction in August 2026 to address dropped calls, slow speeds and coverage gaps	ADVANCED
Ghana-Burkina Faso frequency coordination agreement	No agreement with Burkina Faso	Coordination agreement finalised with agreed cross-border signal-strength thresholds, in response to consumer interference complaints	ADVANCED
MTN Ghana capital expenditure	<i>Baseline not held</i>	GHS 2,100.4m combined capital expenditure, down 36.3% on a restated GHS 3,298.7m, with intensity falling from 29.1% to 14.0%	REGRESSED
MTN Ghana capital programme	US\$1bn over five years	US\$1.1bn equivalent over 2026 to 2028, with a first tranche of US\$380m for 2026	ADVANCED
NGIC exclusive wholesale 5G licence	Sole licensed wholesale 5G operator, having already missed its June 2025 launch deadline	Exclusivity deleted by regulator amendment under the licence and the Electronic Communications Act; the rest of the licence and the spectrum assignment retained	CLOSED
Rural coverage schedule for the dominant operator	Did not exist	40% of the rural population by 2029-12-01, 60% by 2032-12-01 and 80% by 2035-12-01, technology-neutral and non-retrospective	REGRESSED, MILESTONES PUSHED OUT
Satellite internet subscriptions	11,982 in the first quarter of 2025	15,384 in the second quarter of 2025, from 2,666 before satellite licensing	ADVANCED
Seventy per cent population coverage obligation	Did not exist	A licence condition on every 5G licensee to reach 70% of the total population on or before 2027-03-06 against the 2021 census, with a 90%-of-locality verification rule, confirmed band- and technology-neutral	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Shared 5G wholesale network	Licensed but not launched, with a June 2025 launch deadline missed	Ghana's first shared 5G wholesale network live, its operator demoted from sole wholesaler to one participant	ADVANCED
Significant-market-power spectrum premium	Did not exist	A 40% uplift on the dominant operator's 700 MHz and 3 GHz reserve prices, applied to the reserve only and not to bid ranking, with the regulator declining to publish its valuation model during a live assignment	ADVANCED
Transfer of the country-code domain to state control	Privately managed since 1996; no transfer proposed	Transfer to a state domain registry announced, with automatic assignment to newly registered businesses; no instrument, date or transfer step on record	ADVANCED
Regulator quarterly telecom statistics	The July to September 2024 bulletin the latest issue, published about eight months after the quarter	Still the latest issue held; it records 38.47m mobile voice subscriptions at 116.84% penetration, 25.56m mobile data subscriptions, one operator on 75.09% of the market and fixed broadband down 6.83% in the quarter to 216,143	NO CHANGE
Satellite licensing framework	Licensed and operating, framework in force	29 satellite licences issued, eleven of them last-mile; nothing published on the framework since	NO CHANGE
Submarine carrier services authorisation	In force since November 2024	Unchanged; a five-year renewable authorisation granted under section 3(c) of the National Communications Authority Act 2008, charging an annual regulatory fee of 1% of revenue, lapsing if not operated within two years, requiring not less than three years' notice of non-renewal, and obliging the holder to retain charging and financial data for six years and regulatory returns for two	NO CHANGE
Dig Once policy	BASELINE NOT HELD	Draft framework finalised with the roads ministry and implementation targeted for the third quarter of 2026; no cabinet decision, instrument or commencement on record	Baseline not held
Internet exchange points	Baseline not held	The Accra exchange past 200 Gbps, but three exchanges barely overlap: only 4 of 39 connected networks peer at all three, so most local traffic still transits abroad	BASELINE NOT HELD
Register of authorised internet service providers	BASELINE NOT HELD	78 authorised internet and public-data providers of which 42 are operational and 36 are not, with 35 of the 73 companies in the main internet and public-data class not operational and the single authorised rural provider itself not operational	Baseline not held

Guinea

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
GIGA school connectivity programme	No programme on record	2,200-school target by end-2026; 585 schools connected (2026-01)	ADVANCED
MEDUSA Africa submarine cable (second landing)	Did not exist	Construction and maintenance agreement signed to land the cable at Conakry, with the state-majority landing party alongside a mobile operator, framed by the communications minister as securing a second submarine cable after the 2012 system	ADVANCED
National fibre backbone	50 Gbps, ~12,000 km of fibre	200 Gbps, ~12,000 km reaching all regions (2026-01)	ADVANCED
Restriction on Facebook, YouTube and TikTok	Not in force	In force from 28 July 2026, covering Facebook, YouTube and TikTok; still running 2026-08-07; a consumer-protection union additionally reports WhatsApp restricted and bandwidth broadly reduced for several months, with ISPs and mobile operators stating the decision was not theirs (2026-08-04); no authority has acknowledged it	ADVANCED, RESTRICTION IMPOSED
Univ Connect higher-education fibre (ANSUTEN)	No programme on record	17 institutions contracted, 13 connected	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Via Africa submarine cable (third landing)	Did not exist	Co-investment agreed; no landing date published	ADVANCED
ACE submarine cable (sole international link)	Sole landing, saturated	Sole landing in service, saturated; two further landings contracted	NO CHANGE
Guinea-Sierra Leone backbone interconnection (Pamelap)	42.5 Gbps rising to 100 Gbps	100 Gbps	NO CHANGE
State shareholding in MTN Guinee	State holds 87.5%; ~3m subscribers	State holds 87.5%	NO CHANGE
FTTH and Wifi-Zone licensing regime	Baseline not held	FTTH restricted and Wifi-Zone activity barred, contested by the operators' union	BASELINE NOT HELD

Guinea-Bissau

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
WARDIP-GB National Fibre-Optic Backbone	WARDIP programme launched (five components); no fixed backbone design published yet; Guinea-Bissau still lacked a national backbone and was seeking deployment experience from Chad (Aug 2025)	2,877 km design specified (56 nodes, 4 phases, >99% population coverage target, private wholesale operator under exclusive licence); EIASS safeguards study published, project moving toward implementation procurement, not yet built	ADVANCED
ACE (Africa Coast to Europe) submarine cable landing	Live since March 2023; sole international connectivity link, national backbone still absent	Unchanged; still the sole international submarine link, WARDIP-GB national backbone not yet operational	NO CHANGE
Starlink satellite internet service	Commercially live since 2025-06-19, Guinea-Bissau's 7th West African / 20th continental Starlink market	Commercially live, unchanged; no newer status update on file	NO CHANGE

Kenya

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Amazon Leo gateway licence application	Did not exist	Applied for: a fifteen-year international gateway operator licence covering a satellite earth station and network control centre, following an earlier network facilities provider application	ADVANCED
Communications Equipment Distributor licence	Did not exist	Mandatory before equipment type approval and TradeNet clearance; KSh 1m or three years for non-compliance	ADVANCED
LINX Nairobi internet exchange	Operating; peer count not held and combined traffic one-twentieth of current	55-plus connected networks including TikTok and Starlink; combined Nairobi and Mombasa exchange traffic 330 Gbps, twentyfold in a year	ADVANCED
Regional communications satellite feasibility study	Did not exist	Uganda, Kenya, Rwanda and South Sudan opened a joint bank account to fund a feasibility study for a regional communications satellite, taking partner-state contributions with a 30 September 2026 deadline to deposit and launch the study, under the roadmap settled at the April 2026 Nairobi meeting	ADVANCED
Safaricom 25-year unified licence	Temporary two-year unified permit, historic term ten years	25-year unified licence consolidating spectrum and authorisations; licence-related costs about US\$126.7m in the year to March 2026	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Starlink Direct-to-Cell with Airtel Kenya	No direct satellite-to-handset service in Kenya	Pilot reported successful; would be Kenya's first direct-to-cell service on compatible handsets with no extra SIM or charge, conditional on CA approval	ADVANCED
Starlink Kenya fixed broadband	17,425 subscribers and 0.8% fixed share, 359 net adds Apr-Jun 2025	24,999 subscribers and 0.9% share, top-ten fixed ISP (Mar 2026); median speed 34.55 Mbps, down 26% year on year; orders in seven counties diverted to a deposit-backed waitlist	ADVANCED, THEN CAPPED
Africa-1 subsea cable	BASELINE NOT HELD	10,000km France to Middle East system routed through Africa, which TeleGeography expects to land in Kenya in 2027, taking Kenya from seven landings to nine	Baseline not held
Digital Superhighway fibre and hotspot targets	BASELINE NOT HELD	100,000km of fibre and 25,000 public Wi-Fi hotspots targeted; the regulator reports 2,193km deployed under phase one and 1,173 last-mile sites connected under phase two at 30 June 2025; FY2026/27 carries KSh 1.3bn for backbone maintenance and KSh 528m for last-mile county connectivity	Baseline not held
Kenya-Tanzania Terrestrial Fibre Link	BASELINE NOT HELD	Cross-border link integrating Tanzania's NICTBB with the Mombasa submarine landings, delivered by the ICT Authority with Tanzania Telecommunications Corporation	Baseline not held
Meta Daraja subsea cable	BASELINE NOT HELD	4,108km, 24 fibre pairs, Salalah to Mombasa, US\$23m, ready for service 2026	Baseline not held
Nairobi Intelligent Transport System Phase II	Not held	Out to tender at Ksh10bn, about US\$83.8m, for CCTV, e-police monitoring and vehicle-detection systems at 60 junctions under a 30-month design-build contract financed by a South Korean EDCF loan; the roads authority pushed the bid deadline back two weeks to 19 August 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD

Lesotho

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Lesotho Metropolitan Fibre Distribution Network (LEMOFI)	Did not exist	Feasibility study completed, laying groundwork for expanding high-speed broadband connectivity across major towns; construction not reported	ADVANCED
Starlink satellite internet service	Live through T-Connect, the sole reseller	Live through T-Connect, and reported also carried over Vodacom low-earth-orbit backhaul (2026-01)	ADVANCED
Vodacom Lesotho mobile network	A network upgrade pledged at the group chief executive's visit (2025-08)	1.21m customers and 85% market share, 422 base stations of which 101 are solar, and 2G 97%, 3G 98% and 4G 96% coverage (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Econet Telecom Lesotho 5G network	149 5G sites on 700MHz (2025-06)	149 5G sites on 700MHz; no later figure held	NO CHANGE
Econet Wi-Fi Plus fixed-mobile convergence service	In service	In service; nothing later on record	NO CHANGE
Starlink operating licence	Granted, and contested over 100% foreign ownership	Granted; nothing later on record resolves the local-shareholding objection	NO CHANGE

Liberia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
5G network services	Did not exist	Plans stated with investors still being engaged; no spectrum award, licence condition or launch date published (2026-01)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Second submarine cable landing at Buchanan	One submarine cable in Monrovia; a second landing at Buchanan not yet stated (2025-08)	Second landing at Buchanan sought, with partial funding stated as sourced and investors still being sought; no landing partner, cost or date published (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Starcell International Liberia licence	Licensed but not operating since 2020, under a 90-day suspension from 9 February 2026	Revoked, with spectrum, numbering and regulatory privileges reverting to the regulator (2026-07)	CLOSED
Telecoms traffic monitoring concession	Concession with Telecom International Alliance operating, ratified by the legislature in 2022 and held valid by the Ministry of Justice in 2024 (2025-08)	Suspended, with a joint legislative committee recommending renegotiation rather than cancellation, operator funds in escrow of undisclosed amount, and a corruption complaint under investigation (2026-07)	REGRESSED
TRANSCO CLSG spare fibre commercialisation	Sole reliance on the ACE cable landing in Monrovia, with no terrestrial redundancy agreed (2025-08)	Agreement in principle to commercialise spare fibre across Liberia, Sierra Leone, Guinea and Cote d'Ivoire; no operator, tariff or date published (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Domestic fibre-optic backbone extension	BASELINE NOT HELD	Line reported reaching Loguatu from Monrovia with private firms extending it south-east; no route map, kilometre figure or completion date published (2026-01)	Baseline not held
Starlink School Connect programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 90 of 156 public high schools connected; no funder, cost or completion date published (2026-07)	Baseline not held

Libya

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
5G network	Did not exist	One operator live in central Tripoli, countrywide roll-out stated to follow	ADVANCED
ARABSAT and LTT satellite capacity agreement	Did not exist	Agreement announced; capacity on Arabsat-6A at 30.5 degrees east, no commercial terms	ADVANCED
Ghat to Tahala fibre link	In service	11 of 12 sites restored, 91.7%, most on VSAT backup	REGRESSED, LARGELY RESTORED
LPTIC and KBR infrastructure and 5G memorandum	Did not exist	MoU only	ADVANCED
LPTIC and Nokia 5G cooperation	Did not exist	Discussion only	ADVANCED
LTT and ZTE modernisation memorandum	Did not exist	Framework covering 4G/5G, e-wallet, e-commerce, CDN and terminals	ADVANCED
National IPv4 to IPv6 transition	None published	Operators convened; no timetable or target published	ADVANCED
National root servers	Did not exist	Operating in Almadar Aljadid data centres in Tripoli and Benghazi	ADVANCED
Huawei's authorisation to operate	Operating; suspended nationwide on 17 August 2025	Operating under a compliance undertaking to the GTI; scoping civil-service systems (2026-07)	NO CHANGE, SUSPENDED AND REINSTATED WITHIN THREE DAYS
Medusa submarine cable	Inaugurated at Misrata; Tripoli and Benghazi landings planned (2025-05)	Same; no landing or capacity figure published since	NO CHANGE

Madagascar

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
5G-Advanced trial (Yas and Huawei)	Did not exist	Trial run; no commercial 5G service on record (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Airtel and Eutelsat OneWeb rural broadband	Not on record	Partnership deepened; no rural site count or subscriber figure published (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Antananarivo-Mahajanga fibre backbone (Orange)	Did not exist	558 km in service, built by the country's third fibre operator (2025-12)	ADVANCED
DARE1 subsea cable extension to Madagascar	No subsea extension on record	Extension announced on a 3,200-3,500 km leg via Tanzania and Mozambique, ready for service 2028	ADVANCED
Digital and Energy Connectivity for Inclusion project (DECIM)	US\$375m envelope with the rural-connectivity tender document due end-October 2025	Tender document slipped to January 2026; 664,000 devices distributed by the June 2026 review	ADVANCED, SLIPPED
Starlink Direct-to-Cell service	Did not exist	First trial run on Airtel spectrum, the third African country to do so; commercial launch pending the regulator (2026-07)	ADVANCED
AXIAN 4G and 5G expansion programme	US\$82m of the operator's own investment and a US\$100m EIB loan committed (2025-04)	Unchanged; no coverage or site figure published since	NO CHANGE
Satellite connectivity for ten enclaved zones (DECIM)	Announced, nothing connected	Announced, nothing connected; no site or date published	NO CHANGE

Malawi

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Additional mobile operator licensing round	Did not exist; no proposal for a new licensing round appears in the base at 2025-08-01	The ICT minister told Parliament that additional operator licences were under consideration, and that the President had authorised the ministry to identify an investor able to roll out a network without delay; no bid timetable, licence terms or spectrum allocation is stated. The minister conceded that foreign-exchange shortages constrain incumbents' equipment imports and that earlier licensees who took spectrum without launching had licences revoked, ending in litigation	ADVANCED
Airtel Malawi satellite connectivity plan	Did not exist; no operator satellite position appears in the base at 2025-08-01	Interest signalled in satellite connectivity to complement terrestrial networks in hard-to-reach areas and improve resilience; no partner, licence, capital allocation or timetable is stated	ADVANCED
Communication tower programme	Did not exist as a named line; the acceleration project appraisal itemises component allocations and carries no tower-infrastructure line, the nearest being rural connectivity at US\$20m	The regulator advancing procurement for more than 90 towers, with the project stated as committed to around 100; a study cited at the same meeting puts the requirement for nationwide coverage above 1,000 towers. No contract award, site list or completion date is on record	ADVANCED
Converged Technology Networks fixed-wireless network	<i>Baseline not held</i>	4G LTE fixed-wireless coverage extended to Areas 9, 25 and 36, Airwing and Chitipi, taking the network to nineteen named neighbourhoods across the capital, with free long-term connectivity for more than twenty secondary schools under a partnership with unconnected.org and the Internet Society	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Digital Malawi Acceleration Project	Approved 2024-06-27 and launched November 2024 at a total operation cost of US\$90.00m, a US\$70.00m grant plus US\$20.00m unguaranteed commercial financing, with targets of 2,000 schools, 500 further government offices, digital ID enrolment and an affordable-devices programme; no delivery recorded	Procurement of service providers for more than 90 towers being advanced, the national data centre being upgraded to an AI-ready state, and 25 e-services being onboarded to the data-exchange platform	ADVANCED
Four-year ICT investment plan	Did not exist; no such investment plan appears in the base at 2025-08-01	A proposed US\$180m four-year plan built round two projects: a one-stop digital government platform covering passport applications, business registration and tax payments; and a high-speed network linking all 28 districts with ring protection against cable failures. Funding structure, implementation timeline and any agreements reached have not been made public	ADVANCED
Harmonised national broadband mapping	Did not exist	The regulator hosted a five-day intermediate GIS and data-management training at Lilongwe for broadband-mapping practitioners from Malawi, Zimbabwe, Botswana and Zambia, under a 2025-2028 project to establish or strengthen harmonised national broadband mapping systems in eleven sub-Saharan regulators, supported by the European Union	ADVANCED
Malcel licence	Licensed as Malawi's intended third major mobile operator, targeting a late-2023 commercial launch, delayed by macroeconomic conditions, with no new date announced	Unchanged at 2026-07-20; still no commercial launch and no announced date	STALLED
Satellite connectivity for rural schools	Did not exist as a deployment; at 2025-08-01 the base records only that technical assistance had prepared the regulator to enable low-earth-orbit satellite services	30 rural schools connected, reported as serving 100,000 students and 1,500 teachers (company-announced); responsibility for the recurring subscription cost is not stated	ADVANCED
Tariff-notice requirement under the Communications Act 2016	In force, requiring approved tariff changes to be published in at least two daily newspapers seven days before taking effect; the base holds no record of enforcement	The regulator found both mobile operators in breach in respect of the 26 June to 2 July 2026 notice window, and both agreed to credit affected customers with bundles equal to the price difference by 2026-07-31 with evidence of compliance, alongside strengthened internal compliance procedures; the approved price increase itself stands	ADVANCED
Access Communications licence	Licensed 2007, holding a small share of mobile subscribers and available mainly in major cities	Unchanged at 2026-07-20; has not significantly challenged the two-operator duopoly	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Last Mile Connectivity and National Data Centre loan	A China Construction Bank commercial loan covering 136 tower installations and last-mile fibre, with the first tower launched at Mbvunguti Village on 2020-06-13 and 28 towers expected in the then-current phase	Unchanged; no progress report, disbursement figure or completion statement is held, and no account of how this project relates to the Lilongwe data centre built under the World Bank project	NO CHANGE
Malawi Digital Foundations Project	Closed since October 2024; US\$72.4m committed and US\$72.6m disbursed, having delivered the Lilongwe national data centre, the national data-exchange platform and the first phase of e-procurement, connected some 640 government sites against a target of 400, and over 100 free public Wi-Fi spots	Unchanged; the base holds no post-closure evaluation and no independent verification of the reported results, which are the lender's own	NO CHANGE
National Fibre Backbone Project, Phases I and II	Phase I financed by a China Eximbank government concessional loan of CNY 155,432,330, committed 2016 and running 2017 to 2018, recorded as closed. Phase II financed by a concessional loan of CNY 693,000,000 at 1% over 20 years, committed 2020 with start year 2021, on-lent to the electricity utility, with CNY 299,286,770 drawn as at June 2023 and first repayment falling due 2027-03-21	Unchanged; the base holds the two loan records and no statement of route kilometres, completion, operator or current operating status	NO CHANGE
Nyasa Mobile licence	Licensed in 2022, with operational delays attributed to economic conditions and no commercial launch date announced	Unchanged at 2026-07-20	NO CHANGE
Spectrum licence fee reduction	A 20% reduction in radio-frequency spectrum licence fees across all bands, announced following review of the regulator's 2016 incentive pricing model; no fee schedule, gazette notice or statutory instrument is held, so the base amounts and the date the reduced fees took effect are unknown	Unchanged. On 2026-07-17 the ICT minister told Parliament the reduction was 50%; the base treats that as a misstatement of the 2025 measure, since five contemporaneous accounts of the regulator's own announcement say 20% and no source records a second reduction	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
TNM 5G network	Launched at the international conference centre in Lilongwe with a vendor as technical partner, the first 5G network in Malawi, with coverage stated only for Lilongwe and four further cities named as extension targets	Unchanged; the base holds no later site count or coverage figure	NO CHANGE
Wholesale international bandwidth price	Fell from about US\$460 per Mbit/s per month at project start in 2017 to below US\$10 at close in 2024	Unchanged; the base holds no wholesale price for 2025 or 2026, so whether the gain has held is not established	NO CHANGE
Airtel Malawi 5G sites in service	No figure held at 2025-08-01	111 sites across 10 districts (company-reported), after 58 new sites added on MWK 50.8bn of network capital expenditure in the 2025 financial year	BASELINE NOT HELD
Incumbent mobile operator network investment	Not held	US\$31m stated by the second mobile operator as invested to expand network capacity and coverage nationally, to meet growing voice and data demand	BASELINE NOT HELD
Mobile and internet subscriber and coverage series	Baseline not held	An industry association report puts fourth-generation coverage at 87% of the population against mobile-internet penetration of 12.5%, with mobile-money adoption described as near universal; the same report scores Malawi 36 of 100 on its digital nations and society index and 55 of 100 on policy and regulation	BASELINE NOT HELD
Schools with limited or no internet access	No school-connectivity figure held at 2025-08-01	85% of Malawi's 9,000 schools have limited or no internet access and about 900 have none, with lack of electricity and of digital devices named as the main barriers; the 2026/27 national budget carries no dedicated line for school internet connectivity, the World Bank is separately supporting connection of over 200 schools, and the acceleration project targets 2,000	BASELINE NOT HELD

Mali

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
ADSL retirement and FTTH migration	Did not exist	Announced; no subscriber or coverage figure published	ADVANCED
International route diversity through the CSquared backbone	Inland routes exposed to the Abidjan, Accra and Lagos landing concentration	An independent subsea route with automated rerouting behind the inland backbone	ADVANCED
Moov Africa Malitel fibre	Fibre plans at previous speeds	Up to 100 Mbps across six cities	ADVANCED
Orange Mali 4G and fibre expansion	Did not exist	300 4G towers, half of them rural, and fibre to about 300,000 households in build	ADVANCED
SMTD-SA as sole national transport-infrastructure operator	Did not exist	Recommended as a law; nothing tabled	ADVANCED
Starlink kit imports	Six-month lifting of the import ban reported October 2024; prohibition on unauthorised equipment restated with a warning of sanctions 2026-03-12	Control, seizure and dismantling operations announced against unauthorised Starlink, Wi-Fi Zone and walkie-talkie equipment nationwide, with operators ordered to cease immediately	REGRESSED
Universal connectivity target	None published	Targeted for 2030 with a roadmap drafted with Burkina Faso and Niger	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Independent internet service providers	One independent provider reported surviving	AFRIBONE reported the sole surviving independent provider, on wholesale IP transit bought at near-retail prices	NO CHANGE
Orange Mali satellite 3G and 4G	In service	In service; no later coverage figure published	NO CHANGE

Mauritania

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
5G licences	Did not exist; the process opened on 2 December 2025	Four fifteen-year licences to Mauritel, Mattel, Chinguitel and the new entrant Rimatel, bids of MRU 252.6m to 305m plus 5% of revenue; Chinguitel launched the country's first commercial 5G network in Nouakchott on 10 August 2026, no coverage footprint or subscriber figure published The second operator launched its network at Nouakchott on 10 August 2026 under the digital transformation minister; no coverage, tariff or subscriber figure is stated.	ADVANCED
EllaLink second submarine cable	Project launched at Nouadhibou in July 2025: 669 km, 200 Gb/s rising to 12 Tbit/s, EIB and EU financed	Phase-1 coastal landing complete at Nouadhibou, offshore laying scheduled for August 2026 and commissioning expected in the first quarter of 2027	ADVANCED
IPv6 deployment across operator networks	Adopted as a strategy in 2024 with no operator activation reported	All operators have activated IPv6, with one unnamed operator past 15% of subscribers migrated (2026-07) against a 25% end-2026 target	ADVANCED
Satellite internet licences	Did not exist; the tender opened on 22 January 2026	BRAINSAT, VDM and Mattel provisionally retained from nine bids, with VDM and Mattel required to match BRAINSAT's offer; no award, launch date or operating framework published	ADVANCED
ACE submarine cable landing	The country's only international cable	The country's only international cable in service	NO CHANGE
MEDUSA cable, sub-Saharan component	Financed, with no landing on record	Financed; no landing, route or commissioning date is on record	NO CHANGE
Chinguitel network modernisation	BASELINE NOT HELD	Completed; no coverage, capacity or subscriber figure was published with it	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Sahel digital connectivity support	BASELINE NOT HELD	Announced; no site, capacity or delivery figure for Mauritania is published	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Mauritius

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
America-India Connect cable participation	Did not exist	A prime-ministerial commitment to join, behind which sits a signed non-disclosure agreement and unfinished technical, legal and financial negotiation; no consortium confirmation, landing point, capacity, cost or service date is published (2026-08)	ADVANCED
Mauritius Telecom 2026-2029 strategy	Did not exist	A reported Rs 20bn programme across connectivity, financial services, artificial intelligence and compute, and innovation; no delivery milestone has been published against it (2026-01)	ADVANCED
T4 and SEACOM 2.0 landings	Did not exist as a published plan	Named as planned landings, with T4 to replace the retiring SAFE cable; no contract, cost or date published (2026-01)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
International submarine cable landings	Landings on SAFE, LION, LION2 and METISS, with SAFE due to retire around 2027 (2025-07)	Unchanged in service; LION and LION2 still carry most international traffic and the stated driver for new capacity is infrastructure ageing (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
Satellite broadband authorisation regime	In force (2025-08)	Unchanged: service only through a locally licensed provider, a local point of presence with Mauritian-geolocated addresses, real-time terminal dashboards and provider-retained terminal ownership. No satellite service has been authorised under it (2026-07)	NO CHANGE

Morocco

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
5G commercial mobile service	Licence tender open, no commercial service (2025-07)	In service on 3.5 GHz and 700 MHz; 3.2m 5G subscribers, 8.4% of mobile-internet users (regulator, 2026-03)	ADVANCED
5G licence specification and coverage obligations	Not held	Coverage floor: 8 cities plus airports by November 2025, 25% of population by end-2026, 70% by end-2030; terms: maximum 3 licences, 20-year renewable, 50-100MHz at 3GHz plus 2x10MHz at 700MHz, MAD 60m per licence for band reorganisation; corrects the conflicting 45%/85% figure held elsewhere; bidders' own coverage commitments are not disclosed in the report	ADVANCED
5G licences	Competitive tender launched, no licences awarded (2025-07)	Three licences awarded and in commercial service; the regulator stated it would assess operators after the first operational year; IAM's 20-year renewable licence is now individually gazetted; the cahier des charges' five annexes (shareholding, frequencies, coverage engagements, quality of service, interference procedure) are withheld as confidential though binding; the Arabic text prevails in courts	ADVANCED
5G subscribers	Did not exist, pre-launch	3.2m subscribers, 8.4% of mobile-internet users (2026-03), from 2.63m and 38% outdoor population coverage at Q4 2025	ADVANCED
Dual-band radio deployment on rail and motorway corridors	Did not exist	In commercial service; the operator and vendor claim a 13 dB coverage gain, 83% higher average downlink throughput and 3.2 times the active users, with no additional sites built. The vendor puts the deployment at roughly a kilometre of extra range, an 83% download-speed gain and 3.2 times more concurrent users per site; the regulator put the operator at 19.4m mobile subscriptions, a 34.04% share and a market-leading 41.83% of mobile internet at the end of March 2026	ADVANCED
Median mobile download speed after the 5G launch	44.4 Mbps 4G median one week before launch (2025-11)	5G median down 38% from 261.7 Mbps at launch to about 160-165 Mbps; 4G median down 28%; combined median 44.59 Mbps at month six	REGRESSED
Mobile interconnection tariff symmetry	Asymmetric mobile interconnection tariffs	Transitional phase running 2026-07-01 to 2027-01-31, full symmetry from 2027-02-01	ADVANCED
Regulator's telecommunications market observatory	Not held	First regulator-own periodic observatory held (not via a measurement firm): mobile park 57.06m (-0.58% y/y), penetration 154.93%, outgoing traffic -18.79% y/y, SMS -9.12%, fixed lines 3.262m (+5.05%), FTTH 1.5m (about 52% of wireline internet), sector revenue +2.89%	ADVANCED
Satellite terminal licence renewal	In force, prior expiry not stated	Renewed to 2035	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Medusa subsea cable Morocco landing	Supplier selected; no Moroccan landing date (2025-07)	Same; nothing further on file	NO CHANGE
Shared fibre and tower joint ventures	Formed, sharing fibre and 5G assets (2025-04)	Same; no further reporting on file	NO CHANGE
Starlink licence	Local subsidiary registered 2024-11-11 with capital of MAD 1,000; no licence	Same; regulator negotiations reported continuing, and the operator's own map lists the Morocco service date as unknown	NO CHANGE
Fibre-to-the-home passive infrastructure sharing	BASELINE NOT HELD	Prerequisites completed April 2026; commercial opening scheduled 2026-04-27	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Mozambique

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
5G coverage plan to 2027 and 2030	None published	Provincial capitals, special economic zones and main tourist destinations by 2027; all districts and administrative posts by 2030	ADVANCED
5G licence terms and coverage obligations	Did not exist	Spectrum licences issued to the three operators carry a deadline of June 2027 for 5G service in every provincial capital, the same package covering urban centres, industrial zones, economic poles and strategic tourism destinations, with 4G expansion obligations reaching border, rural and other territorial-integration areas in a later phase. Two operators put on record that many target localities have no grid electricity, roads or fibre or microwave backhaul	ADVANCED
5G spectrum assignment (700 MHz, 2.6 and 3.5 GHz)	No 5G spectrum assigned and no bidding process open (2025-08)	Three operators licensed for 5G and 4G expansion, with a first phase covering provincial capitals, major urban centres, industrial zones, economic hubs and dense areas and extending to coastal and inland tourist areas, national parks and reserves; Vodafone reports 210 MHz to Vodacom Mozambique for US\$56m with payment and licence terms still being finalised (quarter ended 2026-06-30)	ADVANCED
Chanida-Cassacatiza cross-border fibre interconnector	Did not exist	In service, linking Zambia's national backbone to Mozambique's submarine cable network; built by Bayobab Zambia and Vodacom	ADVANCED
DARE1 subsea cable southern extension	Not announced	Planned landings in Tanzania, Mozambique, Madagascar and South Africa, interconnecting at Mombasa; Mombasa-Durban route estimated at 3,200-3,500 km; no construction start confirmed at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED
National broadband coverage portal	Did not exist	Public geospatial platform built with Esri and Cellular Expert; operator coverage and speeds queryable by location, with a public gap-reporting channel	ADVANCED
Rural Connectivity Project (FSAU)	Tender open for at least 30 pre-selected sites, bids due 2025-09-19	60 mobile stations across nine provinces awarded to Vodacom, each with 2G and 4G, a public Wi-Fi multimedia centre, solar power, a prepaid public telephone and 100 handsets; no completion date on record at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED
Visabeira control of TV Cabo and Televisa	Visabeira held 50% of each, subject to a TMCEL repurchase option running to end-2025	Notified purchase of TMCEL's residual 30% in each company, taking Visabeira to 80% and exclusive control; under review, no transaction amount disclosed	ADVANCED
Administrative posts and localities without mobile coverage	6 of 453 administrative posts uncovered and 209 of 1,222 localities uncovered, 82.9% locality coverage (2024)	Same; no later figure published at 2026-08-09	NO CHANGE, NO LATER FIGURE PUBLISHED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Internet Para Todos	Programme running with 2030 targets	Running; INCM states targets of 80% mobile penetration, 95% territory coverage and 99% network availability by 2030	NO CHANGE
Localities and schools connected under the ministry's programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	149 localities and 418 schools connected, against a stated target of at least 300 localities, up to 4,000 schools and around 10,000 new 4G and 5G access points (2026-08)	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Nacala-Lobito submarine cable	BASELINE NOT HELD	In design phase; no route length, cost, financier or in-service date stated	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Sale of part of the state stake in the incumbent operator	Not held	The government has formed a technical team to negotiate the sale of part of the state's stake in the loss-making incumbent, which carried a US\$400m debt in 2023	BASELINE NOT HELD
Starlink service in Mozambique	BASELINE NOT HELD	Live, with a Vodacom low-earth-orbit backhaul and equipment-resale partnership; SpaceX donated terminals that INCM deployed at flood accommodation and coordination centres in February 2026	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Namibia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Commercial 5G network	No active commercial 5G network (ministry, 2025-06-03)	Live in Windhoek, Swakopmund and Walvis Bay; nationwide deployment stated as intended, phased and city-first	ADVANCED
Determination of dominant position in the telecommunications market	2016 determination (Government Gazette 6054, General Notice 214, 28 June 2016) defined the four priority markets carried forward in 2024: fixed and mobile call/SMS termination, wired end-user access, national data transmission, and wireless end-user access	2024 determination names Telecom Namibia dominant in all four markets - alone in wired end-user access, with NamPower in national data transmission, with MTC in wireless end-user access, and with MTC, UCom Mobile, Paratus and Telepassport in call and SMS termination, termination being treated as a natural monopoly; CRAN describes its approach across all three exercises (2013, 2016, 2024) as one of minimal intervention	ADVANCED
First privately owned mobile network	Announced, not launched (2025-08-19)	A national network live on long-term evolution and 5G; N\$600m invested in the network in the preceding year and N\$1.42bn in Namibian network infrastructure since 2018, company-reported	ADVANCED
Ministry strategic plan 2025-2030 and national ICT policy	None published	In force; priorities are affordable broadband and mobile coverage in rural and underserved areas, cybersecurity, data protection and electronic government; the policy names high data costs, limited infrastructure and unequal access as the barriers	ADVANCED
Regional subsea and satellite integration agreement	None published	Signed by the state fixed operator with two Angolan counterparts, with the Namibian operator as landing party hosting Angolan equipment; scope covers design, integration, testing, commissioning and handover	ADVANCED
Retirement of 2G and 3G networks	Did not exist	The regulator has instructed operators to retire 2G and 3G and refarm the spectrum for 4G and 5G; the incumbent asked government at a parliamentary committee hearing on 17 August 2026 to subsidise smartphones before the switch-off, and reported 53 sites in one Kavango region against 39 in the other, of which 50 carry 4G and one 5G	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Starlink operating licence	An ownership-exemption bid under ministerial review; no licence; a November 2024 cease-and-desist in force	Licence and spectrum declined 2026-03-23 on three of six statutory criteria; 622 of 624 reconsideration requests failed the legal threshold and two were refused on merits; the operator's own request of 2026-06-08 was dismissed as out of time	CLOSED
Tower-siting engagement with traditional authorities	None published	The ministry, the regulator and three operators met the traditional authorities' trust on siting delays and costs; no agreement, instrument or timetable reported	ADVANCED
Twenty-five-tower programme	Not yet inaugurated (2025-08-01)	Twenty-five towers in service across nine regions at N\$40m in total, N\$1.6m each, company-reported	ADVANCED
51% Namibian ownership requirement	In force, with a foreign-ownership exemption bid under ministerial review	In force; no exemption granted, and the regulator held that wholly foreign ownership raises questions of jurisdiction, enforceability of compliance obligations and effective oversight	NO CHANGE
CRAN Integrated Annual Report	Integrated Annual Report 2024 (approved 2024-09-06, year to 31 March 2024): a funding proposal secured a N\$115 million, three-year Universal Service Fund commitment from the Government of Namibia; broadband coverage of schools rose 31.5 points to 81.5% and of clinics 38.9 points to 88.9%; total assets N\$277.9 million, up N\$29.6 million	Integrated Annual Report 2025 (approved 2025-08-07, year to 31 March 2025): the Universal Service Fund's governance framework was approved and the Fund launched 2025-03-19 with the N\$115 million MICT commitment; a first bidding round awarded nine sites to MTC with almost N\$31 million capital subsidy across Kunene, Kavango East, Kavango West, Ohangwena and Oshikoto, with free internet for schools and clinics on the new sites for seven years; revenue fell 23% to 15.5% below budget, operating expenditure rose 42% to N\$143.1 million, and a N\$32.8 million surplus became a N\$25.5 million loss; 4G population coverage 91% and an ITU ICT Development Index of 73.2% are separately stated	NO CHANGE
Regulator coverage and subscriber statistics	Published to 2023 data	Published inside the sector market reports: 4G population coverage 85% in 2022, with six of Namibia's 14 regions below 80% and Kunene lowest at 41%; 456 of 1,380 schools and 84 of 452 health facilities without 4G coverage in 2022; about 2,000,000 of 2,900,000 mobile SIM cards actively used for internet access in 2022; and state influence over 87% of telecommunication assets and 83% of sector revenue in 2022, moving to 82% and 80% in 2023; the 2023 edition separately gives 4G population coverage of 88.4%, FTTH at 27% of fixed broadband subscribers (more than double its 2018 share), a 6% fall in active SIM cards, and a rise from 46th to 8th in African 1GB-affordability ranking between Q1 2022 and Q1 2023, which CRAN attributes to its own broadband-price consultation	NO CHANGE
Tax relief on fourth-generation devices	BASELINE NOT HELD	Proposed; no fiscal instrument, budget line or ministerial response published, against an operator-reported utilisation close to 50% across about 74 enabled towers in the region	Baseline not held

Niger

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Continuous mobile-network monitoring platform	Did not exist	In service, giving the regulator real-time visibility of operator networks	ADVANCED
Domestic national fibre backbone	Did not exist	2,275 km of fibre across three domestic sections - Niamey-Tillabery, Zinder-Diffa, Agadez-Tahoua - built under an RMB 623.7m (about US\$103.8m, constant 2023 dollars) China Eximbank concessional loan signed 2014-01-02, aimed at raising national broadband coverage from 54% to 72%	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Niamey Internet Exchange Point	Did not exist	In service, letting domestic networks exchange traffic locally	ADVANCED
Telco-integrated satellite service	Did not exist	Live, with the operator rather than the customer holding the satellite relationship	ADVANCED
Trans-Sahara fibre backbone	None in service	1,031 km accepted on five axes - Arlit-Assamaka to Algeria (220 km), Diffa-N'Guigmi to Chad (186 km), Zinder-Magaria to Nigeria (117 km), Niamey-Dosso-Gaya to Benin (300 km), Niamey-Makalondi to Burkina Faso (118 km) - plus an 88 km loop to the national data centre, under a project launched under NEPAD in 2017 with works from 2021	ADVANCED
Starlink retail service	Commercially available through approved sellers	Commercially available through approved sellers	NO CHANGE
Mobile network quality of service	BASELINE NOT HELD	Voice and mobile-data quality found deficient at all four operators in the April-May 2026 control, with a verification campaign running to 2026-08-28	Baseline not held

Nigeria

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Fixed broadband speed and technology mix	Median fixed download speed 13.50 Mbps in 2023, with fixed wireless access the largest fixed-broadband technology and 84,141 fibre-to-the-premises connections at the fourth quarter of 2025	Fibre overtook fixed wireless access as the largest fixed-broadband technology for the first time, with fibre-to-the-premises connections at 265,000 by June 2026 and the median fixed download speed at 34.47 Mbps in the first half of 2026, a rise of 155%, upload speeds nearly doubled to 25.17 Mbps and latency down from 47.9 ms to 35.8 ms; the gain sits at the bottom of the distribution, the slowest decile improving from 2.24 Mbps to 6.04 Mbps while the fastest moved only from 74.37 Mbps to 90.04 Mbps	ADVANCED
IFC financing for Airtel Africa network upgrades	Did not exist	US\$150m for network upgrades	ADVANCED
Mobile and broadband subscriber base	50% broadband penetration (2025-11)	157m internet subscribers (2026-05), from 154.3m (2026-04); 188m mobile subscriptions and broadband penetration 55.67% (2026-04)	ADVANCED
MTN 400G and 800G optical backbone with Huawei	Did not exist	400G and 800G optical backbone with Huawei	ADVANCED
MTN acquisition of IHS Towers	Did not exist	Shareholders of the tower company approved the acquirer's cash buyout of the 75.3% it does not already own; the target's first-half 2026 revenue rose 8.2% to US\$844m while rising Nigerian diesel costs and acquisition-related charges cut operating income 38%, and it has exited Latin America to concentrate on African tower operations. Federal strategic review of the transaction is the last position the base holds on the state's side	ADVANCED
MTN fibre-to-the-home programme	Did not exist	In build against an 8m-home target for 2028	ADVANCED
NCC network performance reporting with Ookla	Did not exist	Two editions of crowdsourced urban and rural measurement published	ADVANCED
NIGCOMSAT-2A and 2B satellites	Did not exist	Cabinet approval for the acquisition and deployment of two high-throughput communications satellites, to be delivered by Thales Alenia Space and Israel Aerospace Industries with NIGCOMSAT implementing under the communications ministry, on an operator timetable of NIGCOMSAT-2A by end-2028 and NIGCOMSAT-2B in 2029 or 2030	ADVANCED
Nigeria-Equatorial Guinea subsea cable	Did not exist	Cable bundled with a commercial data centre	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Project BRIDGE national open-access fibre	Announced (2025-05)	US\$1.6bn World Bank-appraised envelope, superseding the ~US\$2bn announced 2025-05-18; SPV incorporated as Bridge Open Access (Bridge OA), with private investors at 51-75% and the state at 25-49%; the communications minister stated on 2026-08-20 that implementation of the 90,000km rollout begins in October 2026 and that the funding has been raised, against the 2027 start for physical deployment the project documents carry	ADVANCED
Protection of telecom infrastructure from vandalism and access denial	Baseline not held	155,397 fibre cuts in April-May 2026 alone (74,276 April, 79,121 May), more than 54,000 attributed to vandalism	REGRESSED
Removal of the 5% telecom excise duty	5% excise in force	Removed	ADVANCED
Spectrum Roadmap 2026-2030	Did not exist	Assignable IMT spectrum to rise from 1.07 GHz to about 3.8 GHz by 2030, against targets of at least 96% 4G population coverage and at least 50% for 5G	ADVANCED
9mobile national roaming on MTN	Live (2025-05)	Roaming live; T2 Mobile flat at 802,534 internet subscribers (2026-05), no visible recovery	NO CHANGE
Internet Exchange Point of Nigeria traffic	1 Tbps (2025-04)	Above 1 Tbps	NO CHANGE
Mobile broadband population coverage	4G LTE 84.60% and 5G 13.28% of population (2024-12)	4G about 85% and 5G about 13% of population (2025), against 2030 targets of at least 96% and at least 50%	NO CHANGE
Sweden network quality-of-experience project	Running (2025-02)	Running	NO CHANGE
Telecom tariff reset	In force (2025-01)	In force; the first rise in about 11 years	NO CHANGE
Airtel Nigeria retail and distribution network	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 17,200 sites, from about 13,000 three years earlier	Baseline not held
Akwa Ibom airport internet backbone	BASELINE NOT HELD	A multi-gigabit backbone activated at the state's international airport over a commercial submarine-fibre network, intended to carry passenger processing, operations and real-time security monitoring	Baseline not held
FiberOne broadband footprint	None published	Live in five cities, six further states named for launch before the end of 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD
Fibre cuts from road works	Baseline not held	More than 5,000 fibre-optic cable cuts from road works in the first half of 2026, on the regulator's own count	BASELINE NOT HELD
Free-space optical links in Lagos	BASELINE NOT HELD	Close to twelve licence-exempt optical links across Lagos, on the companies' own account; the operator puts nearly a dozen light-beam links in service across Lagos over two years, serving banks, hotels, internet providers and a utility beyond fibre's reach, with plans to extend to Abuja, Ibadan and Kano	Baseline not held
Length of the national fibre backbone	Baseline not held	30,000 km of terrestrial fibre deployed against the 120,000 km the national blueprint requires, with the financier's appraisal stating flatly that there is no national backbone network; the same financier's Board-approval statement frames the BRIDGE programme as laying over 90,000 km and extending the backbone from 35,000 km to 125,000 km	BASELINE NOT HELD
Telecoms sector capital expenditure	BASELINE NOT HELD	About ₦2.13tn invested in 2025 with about ₦1.86tn planned for 2026, on the operators' association's own figures	Baseline not held

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Universal communication access tower deployment	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 3,700 towers to be deployed from October 2026 for more than 20 million people in unserved and underserved communities, with a first tower being installed in Delta State and riverine communities targeted before mid-2027	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Utilisation of the deployed fibre backbone	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 101,000 km built, bypassing some 130m Nigerians (2026-07)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Rwanda

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Country partnership framework	A framework in force for 2021 to 2026 with an indicative US\$912m first-cycle allocation	A nine-year framework prepared but not launched, with job creation the organising objective and no committed envelope on the record	ADVANCED
Cross-border terrestrial fibre route	Did not exist	A 2,000 km protected terrestrial route across four countries, live and carrying wholesale traffic with direct interconnection into data centres in each city. Its operator marked a first year in the country in August 2026, describing a 2,000km protected corridor from Goma to Mombasa connecting Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi within a network spanning sixteen African countries	ADVANCED
Information and communications for development appropriation	RWF 5,395,372,252 domestic against RWF 45.06bn external for 2025/26	RWF 4,851,958,667 domestic against RWF 65,798,446,317 external for 2026/27	REGRESSED
Internet penetration	34% in 2024 rising to 38% at mid-2025	42.6% projected for end-2025 with 1.35m households on home internet, and no measured 2026 figure published	ADVANCED
Mobile and internet subscriptions	13,194,764 mobile-cellular and 10,064,499 internet subscriptions a year earlier	14,001,080 mobile-cellular subscriptions at 97.1 per 100 inhabitants and 10,738,906 internet subscriptions	ADVANCED
New subsea cable system	Did not exist	A 25,000 km system with 48 fibre pairs and twenty landing points across fifteen countries, reached from Rwanda over terrestrial fibre rather than a landing	ADVANCED
Regional communications satellite feasibility study	Did not exist	Uganda, Kenya, Rwanda and South Sudan opened a joint bank account to fund a feasibility study for a regional communications satellite, taking partner-state contributions with a 30 September 2026 deadline to deposit and launch the study, under the roadmap settled at the April 2026 Nairobi meeting	ADVANCED
Satellite reseller authorisation	Did not exist	A certified reseller with packages for health, education and non-profits and small-business plans planned	ADVANCED
Second-generation network switch-off	None published	A target rather than a fixed deadline, conditional on the earlier shutdown's outcome, coverage, service continuity, legacy-handset counts and migration of dependent systems	ADVANCED
Shared tower investment	Did not exist	US\$44.4m of equity into shared tower infrastructure leased to mobile operators, aimed at underserved rural coverage	ADVANCED
Third-generation network switch-off	None published	A nationwide shutdown fixed for 2027-06-30, with pilot shutdowns in selected areas during 2026 and critical-system migration completed in the first half of 2027; extensions temporary and regulator-approved	ADVANCED
Voice over fourth-generation networks	Not in service	Voice over fourth-generation networks live for compatible handsets, with no coverage, handset-base, subscriber figure or completion date published	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Digital acceleration project	A US\$200m World Bank commitment for 2022 to 2026, 55% complete with US\$47.2m disbursed	The same, with no progress or completion figure published since July 2025 against a December 2026 closing date	NO CHANGE
Fifth-generation network	Commercial service launched June 2025	The same, with no coverage, site count or subscriber figure published since	NO CHANGE
Government network	A planned resilient national government network linking institutions to cell level	The same, with no build, coverage or completion figure published	NO CHANGE
National broadband policy	A technology-neutral policy in force with operators refarming spectrum	The same, with additional spectrum allocated across multiple operators	NO CHANGE

Sao Tome and Principe

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
CST national network (antennas/schools expansion)	Expansion plan to more communities/schools announced, larger schools first	35th antenna live at Agua Ize, ending prolonged local network instability	ADVANCED
Starlink satellite internet service	US-backed intent announced, no service	Live: Standard kit STN 5,500 (~US\$257); Residential STN 1,700/mo (~US\$79.5)	ADVANCED
Submarine cable to Principe (STP Digital project component)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Progress tracked as a mission objective; no completion status or timeline given	Baseline not held

Senegal

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
2Africa cable landing station	Landing station built, not in service	In service: sixteen fibre pairs, 180 Tbps, carrier-neutral open access	ADVANCED
EBRD network facility	Did not exist: the bank held no Senegal investment	A senior facility of up to EUR 270m, EUR 170m committed and EUR 100m uncommitted, for 4G, 5G and accelerated fibre in Senegal and Kenya	ADVANCED
Fixed broadband subscribers	About 0.92m (2024, implied by the stated growth)	1.16m at 2025-12-31, of which more than 640,000 fibre-to-the-home	ADVANCED
Gandoul teleport satellite gateway	Did not exist: a 1972-era teleport with no low-orbit gateway	Sixteen new antennas and a Tier III room linking a low-orbit constellation to terrestrial networks	ADVANCED
Satellite operating authorisation	Did not exist: no satellite-operator authorisation framework and no service live	A five-year renewable authorisation with local-supervision, data-sovereignty and local-operator clauses, with the regulator enforcing against unauthorised Wi-Fi resale	ADVANCED
Senegal, Togo and Benin free roaming	Did not exist between the three states	Free incoming calls for up to thirty consecutive days, outgoing calls and messages at visited-country local rates, and surcharges on incoming international traffic removed	ADVANCED
Tower operator investment	Did not exist as a stated position	An announced intent of US\$150m, with no signed agreement, schedule, site count, disbursement window or counterparty operator	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Universal connectivity project	No state free-connectivity programme and no satellite operator authorised	A kit tour running across three regions, with a first lot of 200 of 1,000 gifted kits; the one-million-beneficiary target moved from the first half of 2026 to end-2026, with no beneficiary count published	ADVANCED, SLIPPED
Via Africa cable landing	Did not exist	Senegal a named landing point on an Atlantic corridor of over 20,000 km; a three to four year build with no Senegal-specific date	ADVANCED
Mobile network latency	BASELINE NOT HELD	35.4 ms, second in sub-Saharan Africa behind Togo at 28.8 ms	Baseline not held
Rural household internet access	BASELINE NOT HELD	3% of rural households	Baseline not held

Seychelles

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Airtel Seychelles 5G network	No 5G service; network being relocated/virtualised into new datacentre (2025-08)	Commercial 5G live, second operator after CWS	ADVANCED
Starlink Seychelles (satellite ISP)	Did not exist	Live nationally, subscriptions open online, several users already active (2026-07-21/22); 28th of 54 African markets on sale	ADVANCED
Cable & Wireless Seychelles 4G/5G network	5G live since Jul 2020, unchanged at 2025-08 baseline	Unchanged; now running alongside Airtel's newer 5G network	NO CHANGE
Hytera-CWS emergency-communications MoU	MoU signed, no build reported (2025-08 baseline)	Unchanged – no build, commissioning date or further progress on record	NO CHANGE

Sierra Leone

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
CSquared West Africa backbone and 2Africa West capacity	Backbone reaching Sierra Leone with no independent 2Africa route (2025-07)	2Africa West capacity added, giving automated rerouting across physically diverse paths (2026-07)	ADVANCED
National fibre backbone (SALCAB)	International capacity reported at 500+ Gbps after the SALCAB privatisation, up from 90 Gbps; no district count published (2025-07)	Fibre in 14 of 16 districts against about US\$400m invested in telecoms, with a 60% usage gap (2026-05)	ADVANCED, MARGINAL
Sierratel relaunch as an MVNO	State telco carrying about US\$6.3m in employee obligations and about US\$35m external debt after failed privatisations, with no partner (2025-07)	Revenue-share MVNO model agreed with Africell, which held 54.51% market share at end-2024; no relaunch date published (2026-04)	ADVANCED
Starlink connectivity for 300 government health facilities	Did not exist	One of 300 facilities connected; cost, funder, procurement route, contract term and data-residency arrangement all unpublished (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Starlink licensed satellite service	Licensed and operating; 12 universities connected through ELCOME SL (2025-01)	Two years licensed with three resellers, and the state buying it for health facilities (2026)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Second submarine cable landing	Feasibility assessment under way, no landing party or route (2025-07)	Still at feasibility, with a US\$15m investment cited at 2026 stakeholder meetings; no route, landing party or date published	NO CHANGE
SOGEB-Leonecom fibre interconnection at Pamelap	Interconnected at 42.5 Gbps under the Guinea-Sierra Leone Digital Pact 2024 (2025-06)	42.5 Gbps, with 100 Gbps stated for 2026; no upgrade confirmed on the record	NO CHANGE
Spectrum licensing and management framework	BASELINE NOT HELD	Regulator seeking 15-20-year licences, staggered spectrum fees, NGSO guidelines and an automated spectrum management system; none adopted on the record (2026-03)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Somalia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Starlink satellite service	Licensed in April 2025 after about two and a half years of talks, not yet available nationwide (2025-08)	Available across the country at US\$390 for hardware and US\$70 a month, US\$210 for the mini terminal, with a first local reseller from September 2025 (2025-09)	ADVANCED
Submarine cable landings and their regulatory framework	Landings at Mogadishu, Berbera and Bosaso with no submarine cable regulatory framework on record (2025-08)	Working group opened on outage management, competition and a regulatory framework; no framework published (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Internet use and price	BASELINE NOT HELD	10.7m internet users, more than half the population; median fixed download 18.76 Mbps, up 67% year on year; mobile data about US\$0.50 per GB (2025-10)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

South Africa

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Cape Town internet exchange (CINX)	<i>Baseline not held</i>	Present at six data-centre locations after going live at two further sites, but still concentrated: one facility holds 87 of the exchange's 122 networks and nearly every 100 Gbps port, against 208 networks and 10,132 Gbps on the more distributed Johannesburg exchange	ADVANCED
Cell C 5G service	Did not exist	The third mobile operator's 5G service live for customers, claimed as the widest 5G coverage in the country because it roams on all of both larger operators' 5G sites at 2.6GHz and 3.5GHz rather than owning radio infrastructure	ADVANCED
Delivered data-centre load	~350MW (2024 benchmark)	~390MW (2025)	ADVANCED, MARGINAL
Draft Radio Frequency Spectrum and Fees Regulations amendments	Regulations of 2015 and 2010 unamended	Gazetted 2026-05-15; oral hearings 19-20 August 2026	ADVANCED
Equinix Cape Town land use	<i>Baseline not held</i>	Tribunal approval 2026-07-14	ADVANCED
High-demand spectrum auction	No date	The 2026 National Radio Frequency Plan targets 1,145 MHz more mid-band spectrum and over 17,250 MHz of mmWave against 794 MHz currently available - roughly 215% more high-demand spectrum cleared for release - but no auction has been scheduled, priced or gazetted	STALLED
IMT Roadmap 2026 and draft assignment plans	<i>Baseline not held</i>	Out for consultation	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
LEO satellite licensing framework	Policy direction gazetted 2025-12-12	Direction rejected 2026-05; the minister publicly backs LEO entry while conceding licensing is the regulator's alone, and the 30% equity requirement stands	REGRESSED
National broadband map (DBSA)	None published	Launched 2026-03-31	ADVANCED
National Radio Frequency Plan 2026	Baseline not held	Gazetted 2026-07-24	ADVANCED
National wholesale 5G home-broadband network	Did not exist	Selling wholesale, 5G-core only, with the first retail ISP due live in September 2026	ADVANCED
Radio frequency spectrum fees regulations for satellite	Did not exist	Draft amendment under consultation, with the largest prospective entrant asking for flat per-licence fees and a ten-year minimum term	ADVANCED
SA Connect phase 2	Suspended pending rollover (2025-09)	Declared ended (2026-02)	CLOSED
Satellite market entry via section 13	Baseline not held	Amazon Leo–Herotel, 2026-07-15	ADVANCED
State Digital Infrastructure Company (network merger)	Road map due FY2025/26	Implementation moved to FY2028/29	REGRESSED
National cyber-security measurement	2024 CSIR surveys	Unchanged; no re-measurement	NO CHANGE
National CSIRT (Cybersecurity Hub)	BASILINE NOT HELD	Operating; no incident statistics published	Baseline not held
National Cybersecurity Policy Framework	BASILINE NOT HELD	In force; the instrument the national CSIRT rests on	Baseline not held
National GIS infrastructure database (rapid deployment reg. 7)	BASILINE NOT HELD	In development (2026-04-12)	Baseline not held

South Sudan

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Bayobab national and cross-border fibre network	No licensed national backbone operator	15-year licence effective 16 October 2025; build in execution linking the eastern and western corridors through Juba (2026-03)	ADVANCED
Mobile coverage extension in Kauto Administrative Area	One site, at Kuron	One site, at Kuron; four further sites requested and an expected February 2026 extension not delivered (2026-07)	STALLED
National fibre backbone programme (2,400 km via Kenya)	US\$9m design budget approved, no route announced (2025-06)	2,400 km route announced and fibre tendering stated to start in the second half of 2026; no construction start or completion date published (2026-06)	ADVANCED
National Spectrum Management and 5G Strategy	Did not exist	Development launched; no strategy, band plan, auction design or timetable published (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Regional communications satellite feasibility study	Did not exist	Uganda, Kenya, Rwanda and South Sudan opened a joint bank account to fund a feasibility study for a regional communications satellite, taking partner-state contributions with a 30 September 2026 deadline to deposit and launch the study, under the roadmap settled at the April 2026 Nairobi meeting	ADVANCED
Telecommunications tariff exchange-rate adjustment	Did not exist	Three operators raised voice and data prices on 17 August 2026 following an earlier June increase, and the legislature has challenged the repeated rises and moved to summon the information minister	REGRESSED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
MTN South Sudan mobile operator licence	Licensed	Licensed	NO CHANGE
Regulator's power to order platform blocking	Exercised January 2025; no authorising instrument published	Exercised January 2025; no authorising instrument published	NO CHANGE
South Sudan International Gateway (SSIGW)	Operated by MGI Communications	Operated by MGI Communications, now under NCA oversight (2026-01)	NO CHANGE

Sudan

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Horizon Fiber Initiative (Djibouti-Ethiopia-Sudan corridor)	Memorandum of understanding only (Dec 2024)	Binding tripartite agreement; ~2,800km corridor, 144 fibre pairs, ~14ms target latency, linking Djibouti subsea landings via Ethiopia to Port Sudan, interconnecting with the existing Port Sudan-Jeddah cable	ADVANCED
Starlink satellite internet – regulatory status	Unlicensed since SAF/TPRA import ban (Dec 2023); widely used via smuggled terminals; both SAF and RSF renting/confiscating regionally	Status contested and informal, with a new instance of localised enforcement: an armed group ordered every public market in a West Kordofan locality closed and satellite internet services cut off indefinitely from 26 August 2026, in a decision reported on 25 August 2026 by a local emergency room, which warned that severing satellite connectivity would cut displaced families off from relatives and from incoming remittances in a locality already under deteriorating security and living conditions; the order coincided with reinforcements arriving from Darfur	REGRESSED
4G tower expansion programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	60 towers built; 200 more planned for 2026	Baseline not held

Tanzania

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
5G deployment	1,255 5G facilities and 30.13% population coverage (2025-12)	1,804 facilities on 10,084 towers, 32.83% population coverage and 11.04% geographic, with every region holding at least three base stations	ADVANCED
Active mobile subscriptions and penetration	86.77m active subscriptions, 133.3% penetration (2024)	117m telecom subscriptions and 89.7% internet penetration for the quarter ending June 2026 on the regulator's own count, with internet subscriptions up 6.48% to 62.79 million, data consumption up 11.65% to 1,041 petabytes, mobile-money subscriptions up 7.5% to 87.05 million, and smartphone penetration at 44.74% against featurephone penetration of 83.38%	ADVANCED
Kenya border terrestrial fibre link	The backbone connected to Mombasa on the same route, with no launched cross-border service	Launched by both ministers, with the national backbone integrated with submarine cable capacity	ADVANCED
Kilimanjaro One submarine cable	Did not exist	1,900 km from Dar es Salaam to Mauritius with two branches; construction stated from 2026 and completion late 2027	ADVANCED
National ICT Broadband Backbone	13,820 km laid of a 16,280 km planned total at April 2025, 109 of 139 districts, all 111 service delivery points done; TZS 73bn for 2025/26	15,167 km at December 2025 at 2,000 Gbps, all mainland regional headquarters and 122 of 139 districts, linked to seven neighbouring countries; in one region 942.5 km built against 65 citizens connected region-wide (2026-07)	ADVANCED, UPTAKE STALLED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Satellite broadband service	A distribution deal covering Tanzania among fourteen markets announced 2025-05-06, service not live	Live, with direct-to-cell and backhaul reseller arrangements alongside	ADVANCED
Smartphone users and penetration	29.8m users and 41.82% penetration (2025-12)	28.5m users and 42.5% penetration	REGRESSED
Tower and fibre public-private handover	Under construction since the May 2023 launch: 758 new towers plus 304 upgrades, not yet transferred	758 towers and about 1,100 km of fibre transferred to government across three corridors plus metro fibre	ADVANCED
TTCL fibre-to-the-home programme	A target of one million customers by 2027 set in March 2023, rollout not begun	The target now one million by 2028, rollout begun in 2026 across seven areas; 63,843 fixed lines, third behind two competitors, and 2.78% of mobile internet	ADVANCED, TARGET SLIPPED
Zanzibar broadband partnership	An unpriced memorandum only, with no value, term or household target	TZS 300bn over twenty years, targeting about 100,000 households on the two islands in the first three years	ADVANCED
636-mast programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	636 masts due March 2027, with a second programme of 280 masts stated under way	Baseline not held
758-tower rural connectivity project	Not held	A TZS 126bn project - TZS 55bn from the World Bank and TZS 71bn from the universal service fund - has connected 8.5 million people across 1,400 villages; the same report to Parliament records 14,826 data controllers and processors registered with the data protection commission by June 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD
Backbone users connected in Dodoma Region	BASELINE NOT HELD	65 people connected in the whole region	Baseline not held
Leading operator network investment and coverage	Baseline not held	27.7 million customers and capital expenditure up 85.1% to TZS 323.9 billion for the year ended 2026-03-31, with 444 new 4G and 25 new 5G sites lifting 4G population coverage to 76.3%, mobile money customers up 22.6%, 466 rural sites built since 2013 under the government rural connectivity programme and a TZS 53.5 billion dividend approved	BASELINE NOT HELD
Second operator fibre-to-the-home and business service	Did not exist	Home, business and institutional fibre launched in the capital across Ilazo, Ipagala, Swaswa, Mjini Kati and Barabara za Namba, with coverage to extend progressively across the city as demand grows. No subscriber, premises-passed, speed or price figure is stated	BASELINE NOT HELD

Togo

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
ECOWAS free-roaming arrangement with Senegal and Benin	Not in force; regional ministers had set full implementation by all operators by end-2025	In force - free incoming calls for up to 30 consecutive days, outgoing calls and messages at visited-country local rates, preferential data tariffs, and no surcharge on incoming international traffic	ADVANCED, SLIPPED
Licence for E-Space Togo to operate Internet-of-Things networks	Did not exist	A five-year renewable licence to establish and operate electronic-communications networks for services based on the Internet of Things, distinct from the incumbent mobile and internet authorisations	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
West Africa subsea backbone with second-route diversity	Landing at Lome on a single system plus terrestrial backbone, exposed to landing concentration at Accra, Lagos and Abidjan	An independent second subsea route with automated rerouting, after three multi-country West African outages in twenty-eight months	ADVANCED
5G service on 100 MHz at 3400-3500 MHz	Commercial 5G on sale since 2020, with no published national 5G strategy	Unchanged, and about 1 per cent of devices in the market are 5G-capable (2026-04)	NO CHANGE
Starlink licence	Not licensed, with imported kits in use through roaming in a regulatory grey zone (2025-01)	Still not licensed; Togo sits in the available-from-2026 column of a 29-country survey with no licence on record	NO CHANGE

Tunisia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
5G commercial service	In service across all three operators since February 2025, under fifteen-year licences awarded in November 2024 (2025-08)	In service; the regulator's fixed-wireless obligation carries a 30 Mbps floor and a 50% contractual-speed guarantee, and fixed-wireless lines rose from 9,425 at launch to 319,554 by May 2026 (2026-08)	ADVANCED, IN REACH
Medusa submarine cable landing at Bizerte	Under construction; the hosting agreement was signed in May 2023 and the cable had not landed (2025-08)	Landed 31 October 2025 as the cable's first African landing and in service from 3 June 2026, with Orange Tunisia owning and operating the landing station and the roughly 1,050 km Tunisian segment at up to 24 Tbps (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Tunisie Telecom dedicated Medusa fibre pair	Contracted at 20 Tbps in February 2025, not in service (2025-08)	In service on the operational cable; the operator's claim of an eightfold capacity increase is about its own purchased capacity, not the cable (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Starlink satellite service licence	Application pending since January 2023, with technical trials run in 2023 and no licence (2025-08)	Still unlicensed after three years; the operator opened US\$9 refundable pre-order deposits in February 2026, and a March 2025 feasibility study recommended a time-limited competitive licence, deferred to let 5G and fibre consolidate (2026-06)	NO CHANGE
Cite Numerique d'Ennahli technology park	Not held	The grands projets commission ordered immediate procurement to complete the park at a review session chaired by the Prime Minister on 10 August 2026, alongside unrelated power-station and hospital projects	BASELINE NOT HELD

Uganda

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Active mobile subscriptions	45.7m active mobile subscriptions (2025-09-30)	About 47m active SIMs (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Northern Corridor regional satellite	Did not exist	Uganda, Kenya, Rwanda and South Sudan opened a joint bank account at a Kampala bank to fund a feasibility study for the regional communications satellite, taking partner-state contributions with a 30 September 2026 deadline to deposit and launch the study, under the roadmap settled at the April 2026 Nairobi meeting	ADVANCED
Paratus Goma-Mombasa route	Did not exist	In service via Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi; Uganda partner Roke Telekom	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Retail broadband and data price series	None published	Approximately USD 1.40/GB for mobile data, attributed by EACO to a 40% tax burden on smartphones (EACO regional dataset, data period 2024-2025); UCC separately asserts costs continue to decline without publishing a figure (2026-07-02)	ADVANCED
Savanna Fibre Uganda 1 Gbps fixed broadband	Did not exist	1 Gbps fixed broadband on sale	ADVANCED
Seacom Nairobi-Kampala route	Did not exist	1 Tbps live, scalable to 30 Tbps; border crossings at Malaba and Busia; about 13 ms to Mombasa	ADVANCED
Smartphones in use	18m (date not published)	20m (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Social media and OTT restriction	Facebook officially restricted since 2021; circumvention by VPN declared illegal	All social media and OTT messaging blocked; no lifting on record as at 2026-08-06	REGRESSED
Starlink operational licence	Unlicensed; access shut off on regulatory directive, no terminals operating at 2026-01-01	Licensed for five years on conditions — national gateway, physical point of presence, staffed local office, registration of every in-country device — and now live, with two domestic providers the first to switch the service on	ADVANCED
Bayobab Kampala-Malaba fibre route	In service, 260 km, over 1 Tbit/s (2025-05)	Unchanged; no capacity change or upgrade reported	NO CHANGE
Border free public Wi-Fi, Bwera and Mpondwe	In operation (2025-07)	No expansion, usage figure or further site on record	NO CHANGE
National Backbone Infrastructure Phase V	Utilisation under 30% of full capacity; Phase V approved (2023-12)	No delivery, utilisation or completion figure published as at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE, NO NEWER FIGURE
MTN Uganda coverage and fibre footprint	BASELINE NOT HELD	25.4m mobile subscribers and 12.6m active data subscribers (2026-06-30); 96.2% 3G, 88.6% 4G and 19% 5G population coverage and 27,037 km fibre (2025-12-31)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Zambia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Border-post connectivity upgrade across five trade corridors	No named border-connectivity programme is on the record; gaps at Nakonde, Victoria Falls, Kazungula and Chirundu	A single national standard announced through the government network - tiered 10 to 100 Mbps, dual links with automatic failover, enterprise-grade firewalls - and an independent network specialist firm commissioned to audit ICT infrastructure at five border posts; no budget, timetable or completion date published	ADVANCED
Chanida-Cassacatiza cross-border fibre interconnector	Did not exist; the base records cross-border infrastructure as missing at the January 2025 appraisal	The national backbone linked to Mozambique's submarine cable network under an operator partnership, with the minister stating Zambia is now fibre-linked to eight neighbours	ADVANCED
Government Wide Area Network	Site works complete at 12 Western Province sites, with last-mile connections by the state operator outstanding and the network not fully usable	All 116 councils reported connected and phase 1 completed, and North-Western Province local authorities and post offices connected over fibre; connectivity gaps persist at four named border posts	ADVANCED
GovLink Private 4G	Did not exist; no government-owned mobile network is on the record before July 2026	Government-owned shared 4G network for public institutions, live at Ndola Teaching Hospital, with the national electronic health record and its hospital tier migrating onto it; run by the state ICT institute with three named partners and the health ministry	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Mobile connections	19.9m connections, 92.1% of population (January 2025), down 1.1% year on year	23.5m connections, 106% of population (October 2025), up 1.3m year on year, of which 92.4% classed as broadband - a share the publisher states is not a proxy for mobile internet use	ADVANCED
National fibre network length	10,000 km of fibre optic cable in place, with the acceleration project aiming to add at least 2,000 km (World Bank appraisal, January 2025)	Expanded from 15,000 km in 2021 to more than 45,000 km, and national coverage 94% (minister, 2026-05-15) - government-reported and not reconcilable with the appraisal figure	ADVANCED, FIGURES IRRECONCILABLE
Quality-of-service enforcement regime	The regulator investigating internet service disruptions and requesting an operator report; no enforcement or reporting regime stated	The regulator states it will take visible action against mobile operators over poor quality of service and will publish quarterly public network-performance reports; no report, penalty or named operator action is on file	ADVANCED
Starlink service in Zambia	Live since October 2023, with state ICT institute kits in underserved public facilities since 2024 and installations at a rural clinic and two primary schools reported 2025-09-29	Kits reported at 23 youth resource centres nationwide during 2025, converting them into digital transformation centres; Zambia with Nigeria and Zimbabwe accounts for approximately 64% of an estimated 300,000 African subscribers (June 2026, vendor-market report estimate)	ADVANCED
Communication Towers Project Phase 2	US\$302,034,321.68 China Eximbank government concessional loan signed 2017-08-04 financing a vendor contract, 87.8% disbursed as of July 2022; scope 808 communication towers and 1,009 wireless stations, targeting 92% network coverage and data access for 40% of the country from a 5% baseline	Unchanged; no completion, handover or final tower count is held	NO CHANGE
Independent tower portfolio	Sole independent tower operator with over 1,700 towers serving all major mobile operators; US\$65,523,810 in development-finance equity committed in 2015 and 2017 and exited in March 2021, plus a US\$75,000,000 senior loan in 2021	Unchanged; no tower count, ownership change or investment after 2021 is held	NO CHANGE
Internet users as a share of population	7.13m users, 33.0% of population (January 2025), up 2.8% year on year with the rate unchanged; 14.5m offline	7.29m users, 33.0% of population (October 2025), up 199,000 year on year with the rate unchanged; 14.8m offline	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National ICT Development Project Phase II, backbone extension	US\$333,200,000 China Eximbank preferential buyer's credit signed 2017-12-28, to be on-lent to the electricity utility against a US\$392m vendor contract; scope 2,700 km of backbone across 64 sites, 3,600 km of metropolitan network in 17 districts and 2,750 km of access network; 0% disbursed	Unchanged; no drawdown, cancellation or construction record is held	NO CHANGE
Umoja cable terrestrial segment through Zambia	Announced May 2024 as a terrestrial route from Kenya through six countries to South Africa, built with a regional operator, with no service date held	Same route; ready for service stated as 2027. No Zambian landing point, capacity, counterparty or regulatory approval is held	NO CHANGE
Direct-to-cell satellite trials	No position held on satellite direct-to-cell in Zambia	Zambia named by an operator as a site of its direct-to-cell satellite trials, in an argument for regulatory parity between terrestrial operators and satellite entrants	BASELINE NOT HELD
Median fixed broadband download speed	16.50 Mbps, down 38.0% year on year (January 2025), corroborating the load-shedding constraint on digital services	No later reading is held	BASELINE NOT HELD

Zimbabwe

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
5G base stations	319 (Q3 2025, derived from the regulator's stated increase in Q4)	379 (Q1 2026); 18.9% population coverage and 0.0% rural coverage (Q4 2025)	ADVANCED
Cross-border fibre corridor to Zambia	Public-private partnership signed June 2025; no route live	Phase 1 live at 800 Gbps equipped on equipment rated above 10 Tbps; phase 2 to Livingstone due September 2026; no investment amount disclosed by either party	ADVANCED
Econet InfraCo	A wholly owned subsidiary holding the group's passive infrastructure; no carve-out on record at 2025-08	Separately listed, 70.000% held by the parent, 2,992,163,203 shares issued; 90 base stations deployed in the quarter to May 2026	ADVANCED
Government arrears owed to the state fixed operator	US\$19.2m (prior financial year)	Close to US\$42m, also given as ZiG1.2bn	REGRESSED
Government satellite kit donation programme	250 kits handed to local authorities (2025-07-24)	More than 400 health facilities hold kits, unactivated for want of subscription payment, with 300 more planned; 8,000 kits separately reported donated to the education ministry	ADVANCED, ACTIVATION STALLED
Internet penetration rate	82.87% (Q3 2025)	84.55% on 13,252,877 subscriptions (Q4 2025); the ICT minister stated 87% in July 2026	ADVANCED
Parent company's stock exchange listing	Listed on the domestic stock exchange	Left the exchange after 27 years; the group's listed vehicle is the infrastructure company on the foreign-currency exchange	CLOSED
Satellite terminal subscriptions	40,146 (Q2 2025), the last quarter ending before the window opened	67,057 (Q4 2025), up 31.62% on Q3 2025	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
State mobile operator turnaround plan	US\$40m loss in 2022; US\$160m revenue projected for 2024	US\$210m revenue for 2025, up 62%; a US\$278m 2026 target reported at risk; the chief executive's contract was terminated 2026-08-04	ADVANCED, CHIEF EXECUTIVE TERMINATED
State operator's satellite reseller revenue	US\$215,000 (2024)	US\$3.7m (2025)	ADVANCED
Uncapped fibre package at US\$99	Two fixed operators cut prices and introduced unlimited packages in August 2025	Priced against the satellite operator's US\$100 plan; the incumbent's fixed-traffic share fell from 58.90% in Q3 2025 to 48.41% in Q4 2025	ADVANCED
Satellite operator's licence terms and fee	Licensed since September 2024; terms not held	A telecommunication licence for network services and a national internet service provider licence, both issued 2024-09-06, conditional on the regulator clearing every agent, dealer and provider distributing terminals; the widely cited US\$575,000 is the trade press's arithmetic on the 2021 fee schedule, not a regulator figure	NO CHANGE
Starlink satellite service	Licensed and operating; local resale permitted from January 2025	Licensed, with the state operator and other agents reselling; 17.23% share of alternative fixed internet technologies (Q4 2025)	NO CHANGE
Broadband mapping programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	Under way with the three main operators; no map, coverage output or date published	Baseline not held
National fibre backbone length	BASELINE NOT HELD	More than 19,000 km (Q1 2026), up 33.83% on Q4 2025, against the regulator's 14,357 km at Q4 2025	Baseline not held
Tower relocation programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	Described as being implemented, redistributing towers from over-serviced urban areas to marginalised communities; no site count, cost or completion date published	Baseline not held

Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
2026 Abuja Declaration on Meaningful Connectivity for Africa	Did not exist	Adopted, committing member states to technology-neutral regulation, continental harmonisation, fair access to spectrum and fibre, shared infrastructure and data governance; the text itself is not published	ADVANCED
Harmonised national broadband mapping project	Did not exist	A 2025-2028 project to establish or strengthen harmonised national broadband mapping systems in eleven sub-Saharan regulators - Benin, Botswana, Burundi, Ethiopia, Ivory Coast, Kenya, Malawi, Nigeria, Uganda, Zambia and Zimbabwe - with a five-day intermediate GIS and data-management training opened at Lilongwe for practitioners from Malawi, Zimbabwe, Botswana and Zambia, hosted by the Malawian regulator and supported by the European Union	ADVANCED
Africa Digital Connectivity Infrastructure Report	BASELINE NOT HELD	Phase 1, Country Pilots, put out as an open consultancy tender at a stated budget of US\$165,000, funded jointly by the African Development Bank, the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank and the Multilateral Cooperation Center for Development Finance; the pilot countries and the terms of reference are not established	Baseline not held
Mobile internet users and their measured economic value	Baseline not held	416 million Africans used mobile internet in 2025, generating a measured US\$240bn of economic value, put at 7.8% of continental GDP	BASELINE NOT HELD

Southern Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Powertel-Paratus cross-border fibre corridor	Did not exist	Phase 1 live and carrying traffic, on a route to link Zimbabwe with Botswana, Zambia and South Africa	ADVANCED
SADC regional internet exchange point	No host selection process on record	BoFiNet of Botswana and one Zimbabwean company shortlisted; no award held in the eight months since	ADVANCED
SADC Regional Infrastructure Development Master Plan	In force since 2012, carrying the ICT sector plan for a Digital SADC	Unchanged, with under two years to its horizon; no revision or successor held	NO CHANGE
Regional connectivity indicators	BASELINE NOT HELD	Internet penetration 57.2%, 4G population coverage 79.2% and mobile penetration 95.2%, the last already past the regional target set for 2030 (2026-08)	Baseline not held
SADC shared satellite	BASELINE NOT HELD	A technical submission on orbital positions filed with the ITU and the radiocommunication sector met to secure the slot, with a working group created to assess financing mechanisms and payment model; the project is stated to be at an early stage and no cost, launch date or operator is held (2026-08)	Baseline not held

West Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
CSquared West Africa backbone	Carrying regional traffic on its own subsea and terrestrial routes	Capacity on the 2Africa West system added for route diversity, after three multi-country outages in 28 months at the Accra, Lagos and Abidjan landing concentration	ADVANCED
EllaLink Mauritania branch	Launched at Nouadhibou in July 2025, with nothing laid	Coastal landing complete, offshore laying scheduled for August 2026 and commissioning expected in the first quarter of 2027	ADVANCED
Via Africa submarine cable	Did not exist	A consortium memorandum signed by Canalink, GUILAB, International Mauritania Telecom, the Orange group, Sonatel and Silverlinks for a Europe-to-South-Africa system landing in Mauritania, Senegal, Guinea, Cote d'Ivoire and Nigeria; no cost, contract or in-service date held	ADVANCED
Nigeria-Burkina Faso connectivity partnership	Did not exist	Technical teams to assess routes through Niger and through Benin, on a stated aim of halving the cost of internet access in Burkina Faso	BASELINE NOT HELD
WACS cable repair logistics	BASELINE NOT HELD	The cable's spare-fibre depot sits at Brest, far from the stretch between Senegal and Congo where most outages occur, so a repair ship had to sail from Portland to Abidjan	Baseline not held

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